

Waste More, Want More

Developed by Jennifer Fletcher

MODULE: TEACHER VERSION

Grade 12, 2 to 3 weeks

ERWC with Integrated and Designated ELD

Module Purpose

The op-ed article “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food” by Andrew Lam critiques the global impact of American consumer culture and waste production. In addition to raising important questions about garbage and lifestyle choices, Lam’s article also speaks to immigrant experiences and the international influence of American values. Students will have multiple angles of approach to these issues. For example, they may choose to explore the problem of ocean garbage, the challenge of developing alternatives to single-use plastics, changes in local waste management, the costs of recycling, or the causes and effects of consumer culture, among other options. Because the rhetorical focus of this module will be on assessing rhetorical situations in preparation for entering a conversation, the activities will target key concepts such as genre and the question at issue.

Questions at Issue

Students will have the opportunity to identify and respond to a question at issue using stasis theory. Possible questions related to the readings could include the following:

- How does waste production impact the environment? (Fact)
- What is “American consumerism”? (Definition)
- To what extent has human garbage production harmed the environment? (Quality)
- What should communities do to improve waste management and/or limit waste production? (Policy)

Module Texts

Lam, Andrew. “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food.” New America Media, *NewAmericaMedia.org*, 24 Aug. 2012.

Designated Module Text

GreenWaste Recovery. “Wasteline: A Publication for GreenWaste Recovery Single-family Customers.” Summer 2017 Newsletter.

Module Learning Goals – ELA with Integrated ELD

At the conclusion of the module, students will be able to

- Understand a text on its own terms and develop and support a response to a question at issue.
- Understand genre as a component of rhetorical situations and develop skill in genre analysis in preparation for making effective choices about genre forms and features.

Module Learning Goals: Designated ELD

At the conclusion of the module, students will be able to

- Analyze and apply time markers as a strategy for cohesion

Rhetorical Concepts

The rhetorical concepts emphasized in this module are genre analysis, stasis theory, and the rhetorical situation.

English Language Arts Standards

Emphasized in this module are the following English language arts (ELA) standards for grades 11-12: Reading Informational Text 2-3, 5; Writing 2.

English Language Development Standards

Emphasized in this module are the following ELD standards for grades 11-12: Part I, A. Collaborative, 4, Bridging; Part II, B. Expanding and Enriching Ideas, 3, Bridging.

Defining Features of the Module

The module offers students extended support for rhetorical decision making, including guided practice identifying questions at issue, analyzing mentor texts, and making choices about genre. These features prepare students to take effective rhetorical action through the Research or Advocacy Project.

The following mini-modules pair well with this full-length module: Introducing Genre as Rhetoric, Introducing Stasis Theory, and Introducing Rhetorical Situations.

Culminating Tasks

Students will have their choice of taking rhetorical action through one of two ways: research or advocacy. Students who chose the research option will interpret and synthesize multiple sources that deepen their audience's understanding of the issue. The research option will thus be a reading-based argument essay that may respond directly to Lam's article as one of the sources.

Students who chose the advocacy option will develop a communication plan and artifacts (e.g., PSAs, emails, posters, digital stories, tweets, policy recommendations, infographics, etc.) directed at changing their audience's response to the issue. This option can take the form of project-based learning and may involve proposing and/or implementing a change in the students' school or community, such as adopting "The Last Straw" program (a program aimed at eliminating single-use plastics), creating a school composting program, or persuading school administrators and raising funds to install campus hydration stations that encourage the use of refillable water bottles.

The module does not direct students toward a predetermined stance on an issue. Students selecting the research option, for instance, may choose to explore the importance of plastics, recent innovations in the plastics industry, or the costs of recycling for small businesses, among many other options. It will be the student's responsibility to identify a relevant question at issue and make a meaningful contribution to the conversation.

Because some of the optional research activities require extended time and planning (e.g., gathering data on food waste for a week or visiting a waste management facility), it's a good idea for students to start gathering their evidence for the final writing task early in the module.

Module Background

The activities throughout the Reading Rhetorically section engage students in a rhetorical analysis of the op-ed article “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food” by award-winning Vietnamese American writer Andrew Lam. Lam's 2005 collection of essays, *Perfume Dreams*, is a lyrical reflection on the meaning of home, displacement, and memory. “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food” first appeared as an opinion piece on New America Media, a Web collaborative of thousands of ethnic news organizations, for which Lam served as an editor.

Throughout the following activities, students are asked to read closely as they work to understand the nuances of Lam's audience, occasion, and purpose, as well his use of ethos, pathos, and logos—all key components of the rhetorical situation. Notice how the text-dependent questions move students beyond an identification of **what** Lam says to an analysis of **how**, **why**, and **for whom** Lam says it. This inquiry-based approach helps students see that the choices Lam makes about his content, organizational structure, and style are contingent on the rhetorical situation.

Andrew Lam's article “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food” serves as a shared entry point into the different conversations students will be joining in the Writing Rhetorically section of this module. The shared reading also gives you a chance to model—and students a chance to practice—the textual analysis skills they will apply independently when reading sources for their research or advocacy projects.

NOTE: ERWC Modules with Integrated and Designated ELD: Modules with integrated ELD instruction support the acquisition of academic English for all students including English learners (ELs). The designated ELD curriculum additionally provides a full college-preparatory course for English learners at the Expanding and Bridging levels. In order to make collaboration between the teachers of the ERWC and companion ELD classes as seamless as possible, the Module Plan lays out two parallel curriculums following a day-by-day sequence. Intended for 50 minute periods, it shows the activities designed for both settings and the accompanying ELA and ELD standards. The Module Plan can serve as the basis for adapting the module for the variety of settings in which instruction is delivered.

Each module is organized by days. In the Teacher Version, each day begins with the activities intended for the ERWC class and specifies the activity name, following the ERWC template, the purpose and suggested time for each activity along with a suggested procedure for teachers to consult as they plan how to implement the activity. Shaded boxes indicate student activities (possible handouts) with sample student responses in *italics*. In most cases, the italicized responses are not meant to be definitive correct answers; rather they are an example of an acceptable level of understanding. In addition, many activities exist only in the Teacher Version since no separate handout is required. The corresponding day for the designated class follows immediately and is set apart in a box with double borders. It follows the same pattern of activity name, suggested time, purpose, and procedure with a shaded box for student activities. In the event the module is being used where ELs do not have access to a designated class, the ELA teacher is encouraged to pull in activities from the designated portion of the module to support the academic language development of English learners and other students in the ERWC class.

Reading Rhetorically

Text 1 - Lam, “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food”

Preparing to Read

Day 1

Activity 1: Getting Ready to Read – Pre-Reading Quiz

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Start by asking your students to take the following quiz on the topic of food waste, consumption, and garbage. The purpose of this quiz is to activate students’ prior knowledge and to orient them to the topic of Lam’s article.

Activity 1: Getting Ready to Read – Pre-Reading Quiz

Before you read “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food” by Andrew Lam, complete the following quiz on the topic of food waste, consumption, and garbage.

1. How many pounds of trash does the average American throw away each day?
 - a) 2 or less
 - b) 5
 - c) 7
 - d) 12 or more
2. What’s the dollar value of the amount of food an average American family of four throws away each year?
 - a) \$500 or less
 - b) \$1,000
 - c) \$1,600
 - d) \$2,200 or more
3. What percentage of the world’s energy resources does the United States consume?
 - a) 7% or less
 - b) 30%
 - c) 20%
 - d) 55% or more
4. Approximately how big is the Eastern Great Garbage Patch?
 - a) The size of Oregon
 - b) The size of New Hampshire
 - c) The size of California
 - d) The size of Texas

Activity 2: Getting Ready to Read – Understanding Context

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

You may want to guide your class through the next activity. If students do not have one-to-one access to computers, you may use a smartboard or projector to lead a whole-class tour of the Web sites.

Activity 2: Getting Ready to Read – Understanding Context

Now visit the following Web sites and read the “About Us” page for each organization. Then talk about what goals, beliefs, interest, and values the members of these organizations might have in common. How can you find out if these organizations are reputable sources?

- Global Alliance for Incinerator Alternatives: www.no-burn.org/about-gaia/
- Natural Resources Defense Council: www.nrdc.org/about

Write your observations in your notes.

The organizations want to find ways to reduce toxins and ways to stop so much pollution to our ecosystem from occurring. They’re looking for solutions.

They want to propose ways that we can help.

Activity 3: Exploring Key Concepts – Concept Map

Suggested Time: 25 minutes

Use a concept map to explore the idea of “consumption” with your students. (Adapted from *Words, Words, Words* by Janet Allen)

Activity 3: Exploring Key Concepts – Concept Map

Complete the concept map for the word “consumption.” Use a dictionary to define this term, and brainstorm examples of key characteristics of consumption after conducting a quick internet search or talking with a partner. Then write an original sentence using the word. In the box that says “things that are related to this concept,” list any behaviors, businesses, products, systems, academic disciplines, benefits, challenges, or anything else that you see as related to consumption. Finally, draw a picture illustrating the idea of consumption.

Concept: Consumption	Definition:
Key Characteristics:	Sentence:
Things that are related to this concept:	Picture or diagram:

Activity 4: Making Predictions and Asking Questions

Next, find David Suzicki's book *The Sacred Balance: Rediscovering Our Place in Nature* through an online bookseller such as Amazon or Barnes and Noble and read the publisher overview and customer reviews on the Web site with your class.

Activities 4 and 5 continue to build a context for reading the article. These activities may be completed in class or as homework.

Activity 4: Making Predictions and Asking Questions

Locate David Suzicki's book *The Sacred Balance: Rediscovering Our Place in Nature* through an online bookseller such as Amazon.com. After reading the description and some of the reviews of Suzicki's book, respond to the questions that follow in your notes.

- What kind of readers might be interested in Suzicki's book?
People who may be interested are those who connect with nature and realize there is a connection between us and what Earth has to provide us.
- What other books or magazines might Suzicki's readers like?
Thorn Hartmann's The Last Hours of Ancient Sunlight
- What activities, hobbies, or political causes might be important to these readers?
Recycling and ways we can save the environment.

Be prepared to share your responses with a partner or small group.

Activity 5: Surveying the Text

As a final pre-reading activity, ask your students to notice the article's author, title, and headings. Keep in mind that many students may not be familiar with the saying "waste not, want not."

Activity 5: Surveying the Text

Discuss the following questions in small groups or with a partner:

1. Does the title sound familiar? If so, how is its meaning different here?
Yes, the title sounds familiar. It is describing what humans commonly do rather than what we should do.
2. Where and when was the text published?
New American Media, 9/3/12
3. Where could you find out more about Andrew Lam and his books?
You can visit his Web site
4. What do you think the article will be about?
I think the article will be about how our bad habits are harming the environment.

Activity 1D: Getting Ready to Ready – Context Builder

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

Guide your students through a tour of the Natural Resources Defense Council’s (NRDC) Web site: www.savethefood.com/. Start by viewing and rhetorically analyzing the brief video on the NRDC.

Activity 1D: Getting Ready To Read – Context Builder

Visit the Natural Resources Defense Council’s (NRDC) Web site: www.savethefood.com/. Click on the tab for “Join Us.” Then select “About Us” at the bottom of the page and view the brief YouTube video that says, “They called themselves the Natural Defense Council.” Consider the following questions:

- What image does the NRDC present of itself?
- How does the video make you feel (consider the music selection)?
- What is important to this organization?
- What design elements in the video helps convey the organization’s message and image?

Activity 2D: Exploring Key Concepts – Concept Map

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

Activity 2D: Exploring Key Concepts – Concept Map

This activity will help you explore the concept of “food waste”—a central concern in Andrew Lam’s article “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food.” Start by reading through the content on the home page of the www.savethefood.com/ Web site. What is food waste? Why does the NRDC think it’s a problem?

For the section in the concept map on your definition, you may synthesize and paraphrase the explanations of food waste offered by the NRDC.

For the section on examples, list specific cases or illustrations of food waste. These could come from the Web site or your own experience. For the non-examples, list practices or behaviors that you see as the opposite of food waste (i.e., things that minimize or reduce the amount of food that is thrown away).

Concept: Food Waste	Definition:
Synonyms:	Sentence:
Examples:	Non-Examples:

As you read “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food,” think about the claims that Andrew Lam makes about food waste.

Activity 3D: Getting Ready to Read – Context Builder (continued)

Suggested Time: 25 minutes

Divide students into four groups for this next activity by numbering students 1-4. Groups should contain no more than six students. If you have a large class, you can have two groups of each number (e.g., two Group #1s). Each group will need its own access to the Web site www.savethefood.com/. If you don't have 1:1 technology, students can use their smartphones if available.

Assign each group a section of the Web site www.savethefood.com/ to explore according to the following plan:

Group #1: PLANNING > PLAN IT

Group #2: RECIPES > COOK IT

Group #3: STORAGE > STORE IT

Group #4: COMMUNITY > SHARE IT

Give each group a large piece of chart paper or poster paper. Instruct students to read and view all the content for their assigned tab

Activity 3D: Getting Ready to Read – Context Builder (continued)

For this activity, you will be assigned to one of four groups:

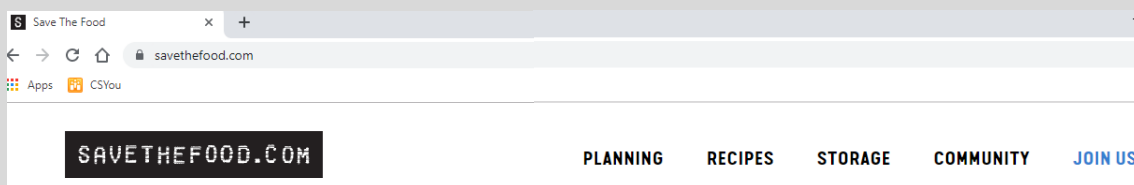
Group #1: PLANNING > PLAN IT

Group #2: RECIPES > COOK IT

Group #3: STORAGE > STORE IT

Group #4: COMMUNITY > SHARE IT

Step One: Use the tabs at the top of the www.savethefood.com/ Web page to navigate to your assigned section (see below). Then explore this section with your group, clicking on additional content under that tab and viewing any videos or resources that are shared. What does this section say? What does it do? How is it designed? Discuss your observations with your group.



Step Two: Create a poster as a group highlighting the key content and features of the section you explored. Use bullet points, drawings, and any other strategies you like to communicate the message and purpose of this section. Present your poster to the rest of the class.

Reading Purposefully

Day 2

Activity 6: Reading for Understanding (with a Review of Activities 4 and 5)

Suggested Time: 10 minutes (for Review), 15 minutes (for Activity)

The first reading provides a sense of the text and helps readers identify main ideas as well as evidence to support their developing interpretations. Students initially read with the grain, or “play the believing game,” agreeing with and summarizing the author as they examine their predictions.

In order to address the variety of learners in a classroom, it is important to have options for students to engage with and understand a reading. Consider any additional materials you might provide that could support this reading for understanding. For example, you might share an outline of the key ideas (using the sample descriptive outline) or model annotations (using the annotation cue cards).

Students will need hard copies of the text for these activities.

Before students read Lam’s article, you may want to spend a few minutes reviewing students’ responses to Activity 4 and Activity 5, especially if these were completed outside of class.

Activity 6: Reading for Understanding (with a Review of Activities 4 and 5)

Discuss your responses to Activities 4 and 5 with a partner or small group. Keep these predictions and questions in mind as you read the article for the first time.

Read “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food” by Andrew Lam. Try to postpone your judgment during this initial reading as you work to understand Lam’s central argument.

Activity 7: Annotating and Questioning the Text

Suggested Time: 25 minutes

Annotating a text enables readers to explore more deeply how a text works to inform or persuade its readers. As students reread “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food,” ask them to annotate it by making marginal notations (e.g., asking questions, expressing surprise, disagreeing, elaborating, and noting any instances of confusion). For a sample annotation rubric, see Appendix A: Rubric for Assessing Annotation, Summary, and Response.

Activity 7: Annotating and Questioning the Text

Reread and annotate “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food,” noticing both what Lam is saying and how he is saying it. Pay careful attention to the following:

- Key claims
- Types of evidence
- Emotional and logical appeals
- Personal stories and anecdotes
- References to continuity and change
- Cause and effect relationships

As you annotate the text, include your reactions to what the writer is saying. You can make notes about the rhetoric of the piece, ask questions, express surprise, disagree, elaborate, and note any moments of confusion.

Compare your annotations to a partner's, adding comments or questions to your own copy of the text as relevant.

Preparing to Read

Activity 4D: Understanding Key Vocabulary – Vocabulary Knowledge Rating

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

Adapted from Janet Allen

Activity 4D: Understanding Key Vocabulary – Vocabulary Knowledge Rating

Rate your knowledge of each word by placing an “X” in the box that best describes your level of familiarity.

Vocabulary Word	Never Heard of It	Sort of Know It	Know the Definition	Could Teach It to the Class
unprecedented				
unsustainable				
frugality				
virtue				
consume				
ramshackle				
expired				
scavengers				
preserved				
myriad				
edible				

Choose four words that you marked as “never heard of it” or “sort of know it.” Define these words in your notes and write a sentence and draw a picture for each word. If you have fewer than four words that you marked this way, you can include words you marked as “know the definition”. What would it take to have enough confidence in your vocabulary knowledge to teach these words to the class?

Activity 5D: Exploring Key Concepts – Concept Map Posters

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

Activity 5D: Exploring Key Concepts – Concept Map Posters

In groups of three or four, create a concept map poster for one vocabulary word from the list above that you all want to understand at a deeper level. Include the following elements in your poster:

- Definition
- Synonyms
- Sentence
- Examples
- Non-examples

Present your poster to the class when complete.

You can use apps such as Kahoot or Poll Everywhere to display the vocabulary knowledge rating results anonymously to the class.

Reading Purposefully

Activity 6D: Annotating and Asking Questions – Annotation Cue Cards

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

To support your students' academic language development and annotation skills, you may want to distribute "Annotation Cue Cards" to your class and read "Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food" again as a whole group. This activity works best after students already have the gist of the article.

Distribute the following comments and questions on individual slips of paper or index cards. You may not have enough cue cards for each student to have one, but you should have enough "plants" around the room so that you have lots of responses when you ask your students to help you annotate Lam's article. The cue cards serve as prompts to help beginning annotators see the kinds of comments and questions fluent readers write during a rhetorical analysis of a text. They also help reluctant students more fully participate in a group discussion of a text. A few students will receive "wild cards" on which they can write their own comments or questions--you can add more "wild cards" as students become more proficient in annotation.

If possible, use a document camera, overhead projector, or smart board to annotate Lam's article together as a class. It often works best to have the teacher or a single student serve as the recorder. Read the article aloud, calling for those students with cue cards to add their comments or questions at the relevant moments. Students should feel free to put their cue cards in their own words. Be sure to pause frequently to ask if anyone has anything to contribute, and remind students to annotate their own copies of the article during this process.

Activity 6D: Annotating and Asking Questions – Annotation Cue Cards

Use the annotation cue cards to support your rhetorical analysis of “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food.” As you read and annotate the text together as a class, share your comments or questions when they naturally seem to fit into the discussion. Write notes on your copy of the text and circle or underline keywords and phrases. Do not limit your comments or questions to your cue cards. While the cue cards are there to provide a model of close textual analysis, your original insights and questions matter most.

Cue Cards

Question: There’s a contrast between the phrases “scavengers and the poor” and “friends and relatives.” What does this show?

Comment: The word **scavengers** could refer to humans or animals.

Question: What are the connotations of the word **distasteful**?

Comment: This reminds me of the old saying “Waste Not, Want Not.”

Comment: It sounds like greed and waste are related.

Comment: This description makes the food sound like it was still good.

Comment: Being wasteful has two meanings: wasting resources and creating garbage.

Comment: The tone here seems pretty skeptical. Lam doesn’t think we’ve really changed.

Comment: The example of recycling is just a small concession.

Comment: Lam seems to doubt Americans’ commitment to the environment or to sustainable living.

Comment: **Waste** can be both a noun and a verb.

Comment: This language suggests waste is an ongoing problem.

Question: Why does Lam use a direct quotation here?

Question: Are all these statistics from the same source?

Comment: “Planet Garbage” reminds me of the movie *Wall-E*.

Comment: The verb **states** makes the quotation seem like a fact.

Question: How is materialism different from consumerism? Does the article explain this?

Comment: This sounds like another concession.

Question: What does the word **but** do at the start of this sentence?

Comment: This analogy to weight loss makes consumerism seem like a hard habit to break.

Comment: This comparison also makes consumerism seem unhealthy.

Comment: The word **legacy** suggests a lasting impact.

Question: Is the word **legacy** being used ironically?

Comment: “Shop ’til you drop” is usually a light and fun expression.

Question: Why does Lam repeat the word **latest** four times in this paragraph?

Comment: The words **latest**, **newest**, and **best** suggest we can’t be satisfied because we’re always trying to get something better.

Comment: When Lam says he’s also part of the statistics, it sounds like he’s making a confession.

Question: **Alas** is an old-fashioned word—did the tone change here?

Question: Does **mainstream** mean the same as **middle-class** in this article?

Comment: **Collective** seems to be another word for **shared or common**.

Comment: This concluding story takes us from a global perspective back to a local scene.

Comment: Retro-future sounds like something scary out of a sci-fi movie.

Question: Write your own question on this card and ask it whenever it naturally fits into the group analysis of the text.

Question: Write your own question on this card and ask it whenever it naturally fits into the group analysis of the text.

Comment: Write your own annotation on this card and say it aloud whenever it naturally fits into the group analysis of the text.

Reading a text this closely makes clear the array of meaning-making options available to writers. Why did the writer choose this word over that word? Why did the writer select that evidence or example? Why did the writer use that type of sentence? Writers know these choices create specific rhetorical effects.

Day 3

Activity 8: Examining the Structure of the Text

Suggested Time: 50 minutes

After students complete an initial reading and annotation of “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food,” you can help them gain a deeper understanding of how Lam’s rhetorical choices function by reading the article again—this time, while completing a descriptive outline of its key moves and their purposes.

In the case of Andrew Lam’s “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food,” descriptive outlining reveals several strategic moves Lam makes that may not be visible to students during a first reading. Notice how the descriptive outline captures the following shifts:

- food waste → garbage production → waste of natural resources → global disasters
- past → present → retro-future
- personal → political
- local → global → local/global

If your students need more help describing how Lam develops and supports his argument, you can complete a descriptive outline together as a class or you can ask students to find examples for each of the shifts above. For instance, students can identify sentences that show a shift from a personal context to a political context.

Because students will be spending a significant amount of time on this activity, you may want to collect their work so you can offer them feedback. See the example that follows.

Descriptive Outline of “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food”

Para. 1-3	Says: We used to scavenge expired food from the trash bin at the supermarket where my brother worked when we first came to America. Does: Shows the writer’s personal experience with the vast amounts of edible food Americans waste; questions definition of “garbage.”	Para. 13-16	Says: Americans are increasingly aware that our consumer-based economy is causing problems, but we find it hard to change. Does: Blames Americans and their consumer economy for wasteful and unhealthy habits; accuses Americans of complacency.
Para. 4-6	Says: Americans persist in wasting more food than people in other countries despite the financial costs. Does: Moves from personal example/ individual case to broad cultural and historical trends; shows persistence of problem; appeals to American financial self-interest	Para. 17	Says: The largest human-made structure on the planet today is the Eastern Great Garbage Patch. Does: Presents a frightening image of the devastation caused by waste
Para. 7-10	Says: Wasteful habits have serious side effects, including large amounts of non-biodegradable garbage and diminishing natural resources. Does: Links food waste to trash production (7-8); establishes exceptionality of Americans’ consumption of resources and production of waste; lays grounds for making Americans responsible for change	Para. 18	Says: I was happy with the scavenged garbage I brought home in the 1970s, especially in comparison to the struggle for survival in Vietnam. Does: Returns to the opening anecdote to draw a cultural contrast between American excess and war-time scarcity; prepares reader for final apocalyptic vision
Para. 11-12	Says: People used to value frugality, but now we favor consumption even though we’re facing multiple environmental disasters as a result. Does: Notes shifts in cultural values; shows disconnect between current values and current environmental problems; suggests need for values to be aligned to our current realities	Para. 19-21	Says: My family and I fully participate in American consumerism and have not resisted the lifestyle that’s desired by people around the world. Does: Concedes the attraction of American consumerism while noting its dangerous influence; suggests shared, global responsibility; implicates himself in the problem
		Para. 22-23	Says: I saw two women scavenging garbage in Chinatown who reminded me of my past and humanity’s potentially catastrophic future. Does: Completes the frame structure by closing with a frightening warning
Main Argument: A consumer-based economy fueled by the American Dream has contributed to Americans being the most wasteful people on the planet. Because of its disproportional resource consumption and global			

influence, America plays a central role in environmental disasters and their potential remedy, but it doesn't bear sole responsibility.

Activity 8: Examining the Structure of the Text – Descriptive Outlining

Step One: Chunk the article according to the following directions.

1. Draw a line across the page where the introduction ends. Is it after the first paragraph, or are there several introductory paragraphs? What is Lam trying to accomplish in his introduction?
2. Draw a line across the page where the conclusion begins. Is it the last paragraph, or are there several concluding paragraphs? How do you know the text has reached its conclusion? What is Lam's conclusion?
3. What are the other main sections of the text? How do you know? What does each section say? What is Lam trying to accomplish in each section?

Step Two: Create a descriptive outline of Andrew Lam's article "Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food" using the graphic organizer provided for this activity (see Appendix B). Note what Lam is both saying and doing. Use your annotations to describe the rhetorical effects and functions of Lam's choices.

Step Three: Compare your descriptive outline to a partner's. Add any additional "says" or "does" statements to your own outline that you think are needed to more fully describe Lam's messages and rhetorical moves. Be sure you agree about Lam's main argument.

Activity 7D: Examining the Structure of the Text – Sentence Frames for "Does" Statements

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

Students can complete the descriptive outline in collaborative groups, with each group being assigned one section of the article. You can chunk the article together as a class before assigning students to groups (see the divisions in the sample Descriptive Outline for a model). Ask students to complete the information for the paragraph numbers on their blank descriptive outline, according to the divisions you made together as a class. Then assign each group a section to paraphrase (says) and describe (does).

Give each group plenty of time to work on their section. Instruct groups to practice writing "does" statements (see Activity 7D) before completing their section of the graphic organizer together.

Activity 7D: Examining the Structure of the Text – Sentence Frames for "Does" Statements

Practice describing the rhetorical effects of writers' moves by using the language frames that follow. Try completing these frames with your own observations about the impact and purpose and Lam's choices. Note that these "does" statements begin with verbs and are not complete sentences.

Moves from _____

Establishes exceptionality of _____

Notes a shift in _____

Amplifies the effect of _____

Introduces a complication by _____

Expands the context by _____

Intensifies the impact on _____

Shows the writer's _____

Presents a _____

Makes a concession by _____

Invites a consideration of _____

You can also practice writing “does” statements by choosing from the list of verbs that follows:

balances	challenges	confuses
counters	frustrates	heightens
increases	introduces	qualifies
questions	reverses	softens
suggests	surprises	undermines

Activity 8D: Examining the Structure of the Text – Presentation of Your Descriptive Outline

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

After the groups have completed their sections, invite each group to present their work to the class. The presentation should follow the order of the article. Encourage students to add to their graphic organizers as their peers present. Use a document camera to display the descriptive outlines, if possible. Allow time after each group presentation for the rest of the class to add their own observations about the section being discussed.

After your students have completed their descriptive outline, ask them to respond to the following questions with a partner or small group.

Activity 8D: Examining the Structure of the Text – Presentation of Your Descriptive Outline

Each group is invited to present their work to the class. Presentations should follow the order of the article. Add to your graphic organizers as your peers present.

Activity 9: Examining the Structure of the Text – Reflecting on Learning

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

After students have completed their descriptive outline from the task in Activity 8, ask them to respond to the following questions in Activity 9 with a partner or small group.

Activity 9: Examining the Structure of the Text – Reflecting on Learning

After you have completed your descriptive outline from Activity 8, answer the following questions with a partner or small group.

1. What shifts, if any, did you notice? Are these shifts in time, location, topic, and/or focus?

I noticed the shifts between “now” and “then.” The article started in the past, went to the present, then jumped between the two while considering the future. He also shifts from a personal experience to a global issue and from more academic language and evidence to a more casual style. I saw him changing from logical reasoning to a more emotional approach.

2. What contexts are important to Lam’s argument? Why? Consider social, economic, political, cultural, personal, or other factors.

One of the main contexts is the American economic system. Lam makes the point that America’s “shop ‘til you drop” consumer economy is pushing people to use and waste more resources. Lam also brings in environmental science (for example, what’s happening to animals and habitats) and his personal experience as a Vietnamese refugee. The contexts of war and immigration are important for giving the article a more global perspective and showing what’s at stake.

3. What does your descriptive outline suggest about the rhetorical situation Lam is engaging?

My descriptive outline shows that Lam is maybe writing to an audience that doesn’t really get it yet. That might be why he hits hard on emotional tactics and scary data. The rhetorical situation is challenging because it seems like people know about the problem but don’t really care yet, so it’s hard for Lam to have an impact. There hasn’t been that “click” in people’s minds where they understand that the issue is important and relevant.

4. How can you use this strategy with other texts?

I would use this strategy to help me divide other texts into sections and notice the writers’ strategies and claims. This strategy could also help me organize my own writing.

Day 4

Activity 10: Considering the Rhetorical Situation

Suggested Time: 25 minutes

Texts emerge from particular rhetorical situations. Considering the rhetorical situation for “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food” helps students to imagine the first audience for Lam’s article and to better understand Lam’s genre choices and purpose.

Activity 10: Considering the Rhetorical Situation

Briefly revisit the Web site www.savethefood.com. For more information on the original publisher of “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food,” see the November 3, 2017 article “New America Media Is Closing and That’s Bad News for All American Media” in *The Nation*.

- What is the problem or need Lam is addressing?

Lam is writing about the problems of food waste, garbage, and damage to the environment.

- What is the genre and medium of his message?

This is an op-ed article that was published on the Web site New America Media. The Web site described itself as “the country’s first and largest national collaboration and advocate of 3,000 ethnic news organizations.” According to the website, “over 57 million ethnic adults connect to each other, to home countries and to America through 3000+ ethnic media outlets.” New America Media had offices in California and New York and partnered with schools of journalism. It closed in 2017.

- Who is the audience Lam is trying to reach? Do you think this audience is likely to read his article supportively or resistantly? Is this audience likely to agree or disagree with Lam’s claims?

It seems like Lam is writing to an audience that cares about environmental, social, and cultural issues, including what is happening in readers’ home countries. He doesn’t spend much time introducing his sources or addressing counterarguments, so he probably assumes that his readers already agree with him and will take his sources seriously. It doesn’t seem like he expects his readers to challenge his claims or his evidence.

Keep your answers to these last two questions in mind as you now consider Lam’s purpose:

- What do you think Lam wants his audience to do or believe if they are persuaded by his claims?

Lam probably wants his readers to change their habits and lifestyle. If they already agree with his claims, he’s probably not trying to change their opinion, just their attitude and effort.

- What is he trying to accomplish?

Lam is trying to reduce waste and help the environment.

Discuss these questions with a partner or small group before recording your responses in your notes.

Questioning the Text

Activity 11: Summarizing and Responding – No Points Quiz

Suggested Time: 25 minutes

Before moving on to a critical analysis of the article, it can help to conduct a quick formative assessment to make sure students understand the writer’s argument and key claims. The focus of the assessment is on whether or not students can accurately paraphrase the writer’s ideas--in other words, have they done due diligence in listening to the text and trying to understand the writer’s perspective?

A short “No Points Quiz” on Lam’s claims works well for this purpose.

Activity 11: Summarizing and Responding – No Points Quiz

Based on your reading of “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food,” determine whether each of the following statements is an accurate paraphrase of one of Lam’s key claims. Write “True” for statements that represent Lam’s views and “False” for statements that misinterpret his claims.

True or False?

1. Lam argues that Americans’ increasing awareness of the harmful effects of excessive consumption and waste production is cause for hope and celebration.
False
2. Lam sees a consumer-based economy fueled by the American Dream as contributing to the wasteful habits of the American people.
True
3. Lam suggests that America’s disproportional resource consumption and global influence pose critical threats to our planet’s future.
True
4. Lam implies that the financial costs of food waste discourage many Americans from buying more than they can eat.
False
5. Lam notes that people used to value frugality, but that now we favor consumption despite the growing environmental problems we face.
True

After you complete the quiz, compare your answers to a partner’s. Then return to Lam’s article to verify your answers. Can you find textual evidence to support your interpretations of Lam’s claims?

Activity 9D: Summarizing and Responding – Keyword Summaries

Suggested Time: 50 minutes

This summary strategy moves students from individual work, to pair work, to small-group work. You may choose to begin this activity by having students complete a paragraph reconstruction of a model summary paragraph.

Activity 9D: Summarizing and Responding – Keyword Summaries

Your purpose in this activity is to understand and summarize the main idea of “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food.”

Step One: Start by writing down five words in your notes that you believe to be most important to the main idea of Lam’s article. These can be words that you find in the article itself or that you would use to describe Lam’s main idea.

Step Two: Now compare your list of five words to a partner's. Discuss your rationale for choosing your words. The two of you must work together to evaluate and synthesize your lists and create a new list of five words you both can agree on.

Step Three: Join another set of partners to form a group of four. Compare the two-word lists. As a group of four students, you now must create a synthesized list of only five words that represent the group's best understanding of Andrew Lam's main idea. Which words from the two lists are most important? Be prepared to defend your choices.

Step Four: Share your list with the class. As you listen to other groups share, note the choices they made and the reasons they give for those choices.

Step Five: Lastly, write a paragraph summarizing "Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food" by Andrew Lam. Use all five words from your final list in your summary paragraph.

See the sentence templates for summary writing in the book *They Say, I Say* for help with your paragraph.

Day 5

Activity 12: Thinking Critically

Suggested Time: 50 minutes

Up until this point, students have been primarily reading with the grain of "Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food." That is, they've been withholding judgment while working to comprehend Lam's argument on its own terms. Now they're ready to read against the grain, to critique Lam's argument and play "the doubting game" (Elbow 270) with his claims, strategies, and evidence. This dual approach to rhetorical reading develops the intellectual habits the state standards describe as key traits of college- and career-ready students:

[Well-prepared] Students are engaged and open-minded, but discerning, readers and listeners. They work diligently to understand precisely what an author or speaker is saying, but they also question an author's or speaker's assumptions. They premise and assess the veracity of claims and the soundness of reasoning.

The following questions guide students through a critical analysis of "Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food," using their knowledge of ethos, pathos, and logos, as well as other strategies for critical thinking.

Like "Descriptive Outlining," the critical thinking questions require substantial time and effort. Students will find they have to repeatedly return to the text to work out the connections between Lam's evidence and claims, to find what hasn't been said, and to analyze the purpose and effects of Lam's rhetorical choices. Depending on your students' needs, you may decide to have students answer selected questions collaboratively in groups and then debrief as a whole class. One possible approach is to divide the class into small groups and assign each group one of the four subsets of questions to investigate.

If your students have access to the Internet, encourage them to do some online research to support their analysis of Lam's context, ethos, pathos, and logos—for instance, by looking at reviews of his books on amazon.com or goodreads.com or by fact checking his claims or researching his sources.

Activity 12: Thinking Critically

Questions about the Issue and Context:

1. What is the rhetorical situation?

Lam is arguing about America's wasteful culture and high consumption rates as part of an ongoing conversation about global warming and environmental issues. His audience is probably made up of people who like to read these kinds of op-ed articles and are also concerned about the environment.

2. What question at issue does Lam seem to be answering?

He seems to be answering a question about the consequences of high consumption and waste.

3. What's the context of this question? What's happening in the world that calls for a timely response? How big is the problem? Is there an urgent need to do something? Do other people consider the problem important?

Lam asks this question in the context of increasing global warming and natural disasters. The problem is urgent and worldwide. Things are changing quickly, and species are dying, and habitats like coral reefs are being destroyed. Some people consider this a problem (Lam cites the NRDF), but others don't.

4. Who else is trying to answer this same question?

Scientists and researchers are also trying to answer the same question. Lam quotes some of the people involved.

5. What is Lam's answer to the question at issue? What's his argument?

He's saying that high consumption and waste are hurting the planet and could result in a bad future for all of humanity.

6. Why does Lam repeat the phrase "in an age" in paragraphs 11 and 12?

He repeats the phrase "in an age" to show that these problems are happening now and that the time we live in is characterized by natural disasters.

7. What words and phrases suggest the persistence and urgency of the problem?

Some words and phrases are "unsustainable," "In an age," "rising sea levels," "die en masse," "disappear," "dwindle," "ravage," "now," "unprecedented crisis," "pressure," "direct consequence," "threatening," and "on the brink."

8. What words and phrases suggest changing conditions or a shift in public awareness?

The phrases "beginning to ask," "we know we need, and "beginning to wonder" suggest a shift in public awareness.

9. To what extent does Lam see wastefulness as a deeply ingrained part of American culture?

Lam see wastefulness as a deeply ingrained part of American culture to the extent that Americans seem to define themselves by having lots of extra stuff and all the latest things they can buy. Learning to “shop ’til you drop” is part of becoming an American. He also says American create more trash and use more resources than any other people on the planet.

10. What does “The American Dream” mean to you?

The “American Dream” means freedom to do what you want and be who you want to be and have easy access to the things you want.

Questions about Ethos and the Writer:

1. Who is Andrew Lam? What can you infer about his values and concerns.

Lam is an award-winning Bay Area writer who cares deeply about environmental and social issues. He seems to have liberal, progressive values. He’s also been featured in a documentary on his family’s experience emigrating from Vietnam.

2. Andrew Lam has published numerous books and is a frequent contributor to National Public Radio (NPR). What do these facts contribute to his credibility?

These facts show that he is a more reliable source, that he knows what he is talking about. He has a background of talking about potentially controversial topics to informed audiences. He has a lot of experience as a writer and speaker.

3. Is Lam qualified to write about this issue? If yes, on what grounds? In addition to op-ed articles, what else does Lam write? What is his reputation as a writer?

Lam might be qualified to write on this issue. It’s a little hard to tell. He studied biochemistry at UC Berkeley, so he has a science background, but his degree from San Francisco State is in creative writing. He writes blogs, short stories, and books on the experiences of Vietnamese immigrants. His books have received awards and get good reviews on Amazon and goodreads.com, so he seems to have a good reputation as a writer.

4. What do Lam’s experiences as a refugee and immigrant contribute to his image? What do they contribute to his argument? Why are these perspectives important?

It gives us a different perspective, so we don’t just hear about what is happening in the U.S. This is a global issue. His personal stories also bring a more emotional connection to the text and show he cares about the issue because he understands what it’s like to not have enough food. He can also talk from experience about how attractive the American dream can be and how standards of living and lifestyles differ around the world. The amount of food Americans waste isn’t the norm in other places.

5. Why does Lam say that he and his family now identify as middle-class Americans?

He says this because middle-class Americans are the ones driving the consumer economy. They are the ones who buy everything and want a lot. This shows how much he and his family have changed since immigrating to America. He’s part of the culture that likes to have a comfortable, successful lifestyle.

6. What’s the effect of Lam’s admission that he owns the latest technology and has bought more food than he can eat?

It makes him look more relatable and that he is just like everybody else. He recognizes that he's part of the problem now, that he contributes to the cycle of spending and wasting. He's aware of how his lifestyle is negatively affecting the environment, and he wants to change.

7. How would the future Lam fears be different from his "own humble past"? Why does he return to this personal perspective at the end of the article?

The future would be different because there would be too much of everything: trash, tech, etc. Lam was a refugee from the Vietnam War, but the future he says he now fears is one here civilization is threatened by global warming. Everyone around the whole world would be fighting for survival. Lam comes back to this story of trash picking at the end to show that humans could be facing an even bigger problem than war and that good lifestyle we want could be leading us to a bad end.

Questions about Pathos and the Audience:

1. Lam concludes his article with an ordinary neighborhood scene in San Francisco that transforms into a nightmarish vision of an apocalyptic future. What is the emotional impact of this conclusion on the reader?

The conclusion creates feelings of fear and frustration. It serves as an eye opener to a frightening future, it predicts that scavenging will be a common sight because people will have wasted their resources and won't have enough, it creates a sense of empathy for needy people, and it suggests a people haven't changed and haven't learned from their mistakes.

2. What is the emotional effect of Lam's comparison of American wastefulness to an overweight person not having the willpower to diet and exercise? How might some readers react to this comparison? What's Lam's point about the difference between knowing something and doing something about it?

This comparison can be taken as kind of harsh to some people by comparing physical looks to garbage. It could rub some people the wrong way. Lam's comparison shows he's taking a "tough love" approach to the problem. He's being blunt about how hard it is to change even when we know we're in an unhealthy situation. He's making the point that we need to take immediate action, not just talk about the issue. The world has the power to change, but it won't do it.

3. What words, phrases, and examples are likely to create a sense of fear in Lam's readers? Why can fear be a powerful force for moving people to action?

Words, phrases, and examples that create a sense of fear include "...those two old scavengers may well represent our own retro-future," "melting glaciers," and "Eastern Garbage Patch the size of Texas." Fear can make people panic and have a flight or fight reaction, so that they actually do something. It causes people to have a more personal and immediate response. It's harder to forget about things that scare you.

4. What is the effect of Lam starting the last sentence in paragraph 8 with the phrase "Of all people on earth"? What does Lam want Americans to think and feel?

Lam seems to be trying to make Americans feel a sense of guilt and responsibility. He singles Americans out to push them to make changes since they're contributing the most to the problem.

5. Why does Lam say “garbage has become the legacy of our era”? How might it make readers feel hearing that the Eastern Great Garbage Patch has now far surpassed the Great Wall of China as the world’s largest human-made structure?

Lam is saying that this is what we’ll be remembered for, this is what we’re leaving to other generations. Hearing about the size of the garbage patch might cause readers to feel shocked, sad, and ashamed. Instead of building something beautiful, we created something dangerous.

Questions about Logos and the Text:

1. Would there be less plastic, glass, and aluminum garbage if Americans ate all the food in the packages they throw away?

No, there would not be less plastic, glass, and aluminum garbage if Americans ate all the food they bought because this food would still come in packaging. Paragraph 3 also states that even after being used once, most of the garbage is not being recycled.

2. Lam claims that “garbage production in the United States has doubled in the last 30 years.” What do we need to know about population growth to understand the significance of this statistic?

We need to know trash growth per capita.

3. What’s the link, if any, between trash production and global warming? How can you find out more about this connection? Who has the expertise to answer this question?

4. Who has estimated the annual dollar value of the food Americans waste (paragraph 6)? Is it clear from the text? Why do you think Lam writes this sentence in passive voice (e.g., “is estimated to be”)?

5. What is the source of Lam’s numerical data in paragraphs 7, 8, 9, and 16? How do you know? What is the effect of Lam’s use of statistics to support his claims in this article? Has he left any important information out?

6. Who is using and throwing away the products the U.S. makes? Where are the products made that Americans use and throw away? Does the article say? How does globalization complicate the story of which country produces the most waste?

7. How are op-ed pieces different from scholarly articles? What do readers expect of each genre? What kinds of evidence and support are important in each genre?

Activity 10D: Thinking Critically – Structured Discussion

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

Use the protocol for a Structured Discussion to engage students in a collaborative exploration of the Thinking Critically questions in this module. The sentence starters in Step Two were developed by Zwiers and Crawford (32).

Activity 10D: Thinking Critically – Structured Discussion

In your group, number yourselves 1-4. Each person will have a specific role during the discussion. You will be discussing any of the following “Thinking Critically” questions from this module that most interest your group:

- What’s the context of this question? What’s happening in the world that calls for a timely response? How big is the problem? Is there an urgent need to do something? Do other people consider the problem important?
- What words, phrases, and examples are likely to create a sense of fear in Lam’s readers? Why can fear be a powerful force for moving people to action?
- To what extent does Lam see wastefulness as a deeply ingrained part of American culture?
- What does “The American Dream” mean to you?

Step One: Students 1 and 2 will begin the discussion while students 3 and 4 take notes in a T-chart. The T-chart will be a record of the main points and examples discussed by Students 1 and 2. Students 1 and 2 will have five minutes for their dialogue.

Student 1	Student 2

Step Two: Student 3 now summarizes the discussion and then asks for elaboration or clarification on one underdeveloped but important point and joins the conversation while 4 continues to take notes in a three-chart (see the example below). Students 1, 2, and 3 will have seven more minutes to continue the discussion. Try using the sentence starters that follow to help each other elaborate upon and clarify your ideas.

- Can you elaborate on this...?
- What do you mean by ...?
- Can you tell me more about...?
- What makes you think that?
- Can you clarify the part about...?
- Can you be more specific?
- How so?
- How/why is that important?

Student 4 records key points and examples in the three-chart.

Student 1	Student 2	Student 3

Step Three: Student 4 now gives credit to individuals for significant ideas and synthesizes work of the group into a short statement. Groups may have five minutes for this final step.

Activity 11D: Thinking Critically – Logos Analysis

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

The purpose of Activity 11D is to deepen students’ understanding of one aspect of critical thinking by asking questions about logos. Through the Logos Analysis graphic organizer, students create a holistic snapshot of the strategies Lam uses throughout his article to develop and support his line of reasoning. See Appendix C.

Activity 11D: Thinking Critically – Logos Analysis

In your same group, please complete the Logos Analysis graphic organizer for “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food,” using your notes from the discussion to consider the logic of Lam’s article.

Reading Purposefully

Day 6

Activity 13: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – Noticing Language

Suggested Time: 25 minutes

The activities in this section afford students multiple opportunities for learning about how English works. After students discuss their observation about the sentences in Activity 13, guide your students through the explanations of “Complete Verb Phrases,” “Helping and Modal Verbs,” “Time and Tense,” and “Time Frames and Time Markers” that follow. You may want to display this section electronically while your students take notes. You might invite students to read particular sections aloud or you can prepare a mini-lecture on this material. Pause periodically to ask your students to explain a term or concept, such as “complete verb phrase,” to a partner before moving on with the explanations. Frequently check for student understanding.

Activity 13 includes time for taking notes.

(Adapted from materials developed by Roberta Ching)

Activity 13: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – Noticing Language

What do you notice about these sentences?

1. In the 1970s America is wasting less food than it does today.
2. Andrew Lam came to America from Vietnam since the mid-1970s.
3. Today, the United States has less than 5% of the world’s population, but it used more than 30% of the world’s energy resources.

Discuss your observations with a partner. Then take notes on the content that follows:

Complete Verb Phrases

- Have a grammatical subject (I, you, it...)

subj

Example: Lam has the latest technology.

- Express a time (tense), completion (aspect), or duration

verb

Example: He saw (past tense) two Chinese women looking for aluminum cans.

- Can have one, two, or three helping or modal verbs

modal.....main

Example: Few can resist the appeal of consumerism.

- Always have a main verb (a verb that carries meaning)

Main

Example: Garbage production in the United States has doubled in the last 30 years.

Helping and Modal Verbs

- “Be” verbs: is, am, are, was, were, been
- “Have” verbs: have, has, had
- “Do” verbs: do, does, did
- Modals: can, will, must, should, may, might
- Phrasal Modals: Be going to, be able to, be supposed to, had better, ought to, have to
- Infinitive and -ing and -ed verb forms

Verbs can also function as other parts of speech, such as nouns and adjectives. These forms are not part of the verb phrase and should not be underlined when you are identifying verb phrases.

- Verbal adjective (participial adjective)

Expired food must be thrown away

- Verbal noun (gerund)

Wasting food has become a persistent problem.

- Infinitive

David Suzuki encourages people **to reexamine** the beliefs that shape our lifestyles.

Activity 14: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – Using Time Frames and Time Markers to Create Cohesion

Purpose: To draw students’ attention to the way writers shift among verb tenses across an extended piece of text to indicate time relationships and the way they indicate the shifts with time markers

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

If your students have been introduced to the rhetorical concept of kairos, you may also want to note the ways Lam negotiates both chronological and situational time. See the section on recognizing the language of kairos in the article “Choosing the Right Words at the Right Time” in the Introducing Kairos mini-module.

1. Give students a copy of the information about time and tense below. Walk them through the examples, clarifying that different forms of verbs (tenses) can be used to express past time and present time and that writers have to guide their readers as they move back and forth between the present and past time frames. Point out that time markers are another way for writers to create cohesion since they enable writers to show time relationships among different parts of the text.
2. Pass out copies of the passage. Ask students to double-underline the complete verb phrases and underline the subjects in the paragraphs. Instruct students to circle the time markers that guide readers. Alternately, you can turn the text into a cloze activity by removing the verbs completely and supplying the base form (infinitive form without “to”). Then students can determine the tense needed by the context of the passage including the time markers. For this option, direct students to read the entire passage before beginning to fill in the correct tenses.
3. When they are done, they can talk to their partner about why some sentences or parts of sentences are in the present tense, but no time marker has indicated a shift.
4. Conclude by asking students to report their conclusions and ask any remaining questions.

Activity 14: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – Using Time Frames and Time Markers to Create Cohesion

Time and Tense

Step One: Read and discuss the following information on time and verb tense. Take notes on key terms, definitions, and examples. Generate your own examples to show your understanding.

Verb tenses indicate the time period you are referring to in your writing, so any discussion of verb tense starts with a discussion of time. You can arrange a time on a timeline like this:

Yesterday	Today	Tomorrow
August 23, 2012	August 24, 2012*	August 25, 2012

(*date of publication of Lam’s article)

If you think of time as a timeline, then you can visualize verb tenses as sections of the timeline. The key to understanding and using verb tenses in English is to look at them in the context of the passage they are in rather than separately in individual sentences. Within passages, they occur in two time frames, either the past time frame or the present/future time-frame.

Past Time Frame	Present Time Frame	Future Time Frame
simple past tense took did take	simple present tense takes do/does take	simple future will take am/is/are going to
PAST	NOW	FUTURE

Time Frames and Time Markers

In general, you cannot switch from the past time frame to the present/future time frame without a reason. Often a **time marker** is a signal to your reader that you are switching time frames. For example, you would use a time marker like “now” to switch from the past time frame to the present/future time frame.

Example: Not long ago, frugality was a virtue. Now, two-thirds of our economy is based on consumption.

Step Two: Double-underline the complete verb phrases and underline the subjects in the following passage. Circle the time markers. Remember a time marker can be implied by the context of the passage. Fill in the chart below. In the fourth column, label the time frame of the verbs: **past** or **present/future**.

Alas, I am also aware that even as mainstream Americans are beginning to wonder if our way of life has a direct consequence on the weather, everyone else wants to become us. From China to Bombay, from Cape Town to Rio de Janeiro—everyone wants a piece of the good life in the American style. Our collective desires are putting more pressure on ecosystems already on the brink.

A while back, walking home here in San Francisco, I saw two old Chinese ladies looking for aluminum cans and plastic bottles in a garbage bin behind a restaurant near my home. One of the workers came out and yelled at the old ladies to stop.

As I watched the two elders scurrying away into the shadows, I thought of my own humble past. But I fear that, with the way things go, with global warming threatening to undermine our civilization, those two old scavengers may well represent our own retro-future.

Rhetorical purpose: Why do you think the writer switches time frames?

	Subject	Verb Phrase	Time Marker	Time Frame
1	<i>I</i>	<i>saw</i>	<i>A while back</i>	<i>past</i>
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				

7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				

Activity 15: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – Using Basic and Perfect Verb Tenses in Expository Writing

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 15: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – Using Basic and Perfect Verb Tenses in Expository Writing

Fill in the blanks in these paragraphs from “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food” with the correct verb tenses. Use the simple past, present, or future and the present and past perfect. Circle the time markers. Check to make sure the verbs agree with the subjects.

Back in the 1970s, when my brother _____ at the supermarket, I _____ hauling some of the market’s expired food home to my family with giddiness. What Americans threw away _____ sustenance back home in Vietnam, where children scavenged through piles of garbage for anything salvageable. People there _____ the neighborhoods buying old papers and magazines to recycle or begged for slop to feed their pigs. My own family and relatives, too, _____ on from our humble beginnings as refugees to become middle-class Americans whose motto, at times, _____ to be “shop ’til you drop.”

Rhetorical purpose: Why do you think the writer switches time frames?

Analyzing Stylistic Choices

There is no formal activity for students in this section of the template. Students practiced analyzing some of Lam’s stylistic choices as part of the annotation and descriptive outlining activities. At this point, you may want to invite your students to consider the audience for Lam’s article and the likely effects of his choices of words, sentence structures, verb tenses, and organizational strategies. This could be assigned as homework. Consider using a formative assessment strategy to assess your students’ ability to analyze stylistic choices, including grammatical structures. (See “Formative Assessment for ERWC 3.0: Professional Learning” by Norman Unrau and the accompanying appendix “Strategies for Formative Assessment.”)

Activity 12D: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – Using Verb Tenses to Express Time Relationships

The purpose of this activity is to develop students’ understanding of verb forms as meaning-making options.

Suggested Time: 50 minutes

Activity 12D: Analyzing Rhetorical Grammar – Using Verb Tenses to Express Time Relationships

Step One: Take notes as your teacher guides you through the following explanations and examples.

Progressive tenses are used to describe an event or action **in progress** or ongoing at a time in the past, present, or future. The emphasis is on the duration (length of time). Progressive tenses are usually used with active verbs such as “writing” and “sitting;” they are much less frequent with state-of-being verbs such as “be” and “seem.”

Past Progressive Tense:

Lam’s brother was working in a supermarket during a time Americans wasted less food than they do today. (“Was working” describes an action that was happening at a time in the past.)

Present Progressive Tense:

We are throwing away up to 40% of our food, the research finds. (“Are throwing away” describes a present action that is occurring at the present moment.)

More Americans are beginning to ask these questions after Katrina.

Step Two: The following timeline gives dates for the main events in Andrew Lam’s life. Using these dates and information from Lam’s Twitter profile, author page on amazon.com, and “Andrew Lam: Introduction.” *My Journey Home* on PBS www.pbs.org/weta/myjourneyhome/andrew/ write a brief biography of Andrew Lam. Try to use a variety of verb tenses, including the simple present and the future. You may use the passive when appropriate.

1964	Born in South Vietnam
1975	Left Vietnam with his family during the fall of Saigon
1980s	Attends UC Berkley where he majors in biochemistry
1990s	Leaves UC Berkley and enters creative writing program at San Francisco State University
1993	Wins Outstanding Young Journalist Award from Society of Professional Journals
2004	Features in PBS documentary <i>My Journey Home</i> on his return to Vietnam
2005	Publishes <i>Perfume Dreams</i>
2010	Publishes <i>East Eats West: Writing in Two Hemispheres</i>

2013	Publishes <i>Birds of Paradise Lost</i>
2017	Works as web editor for New America Media

Now underline the subjects and double-underline the verbs in your biography. Circle time markers. Finally, add any needed time markers and edit the verbs so they accurately express the relationship among events in Lam's life. Check for subject-verb agreement and correct punctuation.

Questioning the Text

Day 7

Activity 16: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives – Finding Common Ground

The purpose of this activity is to help students map out potential conflicts and agreements and situate themselves among them. Thoughtful engagement with a plurality of perspectives prepares students to make informed and productive contributions to conversations.

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

Activity 16: Synthesizing Multiple Perspectives – Finding Common Ground

In this activity, you will consider how each of the following stakeholders is likely to respond to a series of claims about food waste. Imagine the cares and concerns that would influence each stakeholder's perspective. If you think the stakeholders would likely agree with a claim, write a + sign in the box. If you think they would likely disagree with the claim, write a – sign. Write a ? in the box if you are unsure of the stakeholders' probable position. Use the letters to record your response for each stakeholder.

- Small business owners (A)
- Local farmers (B)
- City officials responsible for waste management (C)
- Working parents (D)
- Climate scientists (E)
- Consumers (F)
- Processed food manufacturers (G)
- You (H)
- Andrew Lam (I)

Claim	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
1. Packaged foods offer affordable and convenient meal options.									
2. Americans spend too much money on food they don't eat.									
3. Home composting is easy and beneficial.									
4. Eating locally grown produce is better for our health and the environment.									
5. Reducing food waste helps families save money.									
6. Recycling costs can outweigh the benefits.									
7. It's not feasible for everyone to pack zero waste lunches.									
8. Reducing food waste can reduce climate change.									
9. Storing food properly helps maximize the food you have.									
10. Most food waste results from careless shopping.									
11. The more Americans spend, the more they want.									
12. Communities have a responsibility to dispose of their garbage appropriately.									
13. The amount of garbage Americans now produce is not sustainable.									
14. Plastic trash and other forms of garbage are seriously harming the environment.									

After completing your matrix, look for the claims that you think would elicit the most agreement among stakeholders in the conversation. What common ground have you found, if any? Where are the places of greatest disagreement? How do you fit into the conversation? How does Lam? Discuss your observations with a partner or small group.

Activity 17: Reflecting on Your Reading Process

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 17: Reflecting on Your Reading Process

Provide evidence and examples documenting your ability to perform each of the tasks in the chart.

I am able to...	Evidence and Examples
Identify thesis and/or major claims	
Connect evidence to claims	
Analyze writers' language choices	
Annotate and question texts	
Analyze text structure	
Describe the effects and purposes of writers' moves	

Preparing to Respond

Discovering What You Think

Activity 18: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – The Writing Task

Suggested Time: 25 minutes

Students have a choice about how they respond to the issues Lam addresses in “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food.” For example, they may choose to explore the problem of ocean garbage, the challenge of developing alternatives to single-use plastics, changes in local waste management, the costs of recycling, or the causes and effects of consumer culture, among other options. The culminating writing task uses stasis theory to help students make their own choices about the question(s) they want to answer, the audience(s) they want to engage, the purpose(s) they want to accomplish, and the best means—including genre and persuasive strategies—of doing so.

For the research option, students will write a 1,000 to 1,500-word essay responding to the issue they’ve selected. For the advocacy option, students must produce at least two artifacts—one of which must be a 500-word formal communication plan detailing their rationale for taking action and their strategies for reaching their target audience, including the genres and media platforms they intend to use. Artifacts for the advocacy option must total another 500 to 1,000 words.

Encourage students to consider these options and start brainstorming ideas as their homework.

Activity 18: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – The Writing Task

Up until this point, you have been paying careful attention to a single text, working hard to understand the writer’s argument, including how he develops and supports that argument. But Andrew Lam is just one voice in the conversation—and in fact, the argument he makes about consumer culture and garbage production participates in several ongoing conversations about these and related issues. Now it is your turn to respond to these issues by joining a conversation of your choice.

Writers respond to rhetorical situations by taking rhetorical action. That is, they target specific audiences and occasions and use their words to change how others think, act, or feel. For this assignment, you will have your choice of taking rhetorical action through one of two ways: research or advocacy. Students who choose the research option will interpret and synthesize multiple sources that deepen their audience’s understanding of the issue. The research option will thus be a reading-based argument essay that may respond directly to Lam’s article as one of the sources. Students who choose the advocacy option will develop a communication plan and artifacts (e.g., PSAs, emails, posters, digital stories, tweets, policy recommendations, infographics, etc.) directed at changing their audience’s response to the issue. This option can take the form of project-based learning and may involve proposing and/or implementing a change in your school or community, such as adopting “The Last Straw” program (a program aimed at eliminating single-use plastics), creating a school composting program, or persuading school administrators and raising funds to install campus hydration stations that encourage the use of refillable water bottles.

BOTH options are required to include the following:

- Citations from multiple sources (for the advocacy option, these may appear in the artifacts as footnotes, in-text citations, links, references, expert testimony—whatever is most appropriate for the genre selected)
- A works-cited list
- Reading-based argumentation
- An answer to a question at issue
- Appropriate and effective use of genre conventions

See below for additional directions for the individual options.

OPTION #1: Research Project

Write a 1,000 to 1,500-word research paper responding to a question at issue related to the topics of consumer culture and waste management. Begin by designing and conducting a research project investigating your question. Consider the work that others have done to address this issue. Gather, analyze, and evaluate evidence from multiple sources. Look for significant trends in your data. Present your findings through a well-organized essay crafted for an academic audience.

In addition to reading scholarly sources (i.e., sources vetted through a peer-review process and published by academic presses), you may also conduct research by doing any of the following:

- Obtain a food scale and weigh your food waste after each meal for a period of one week. Record your data in a spreadsheet. Analyze trends in your data and draw conclusions using evidence-based reasoning. Include graphs or charts of your data in your research essay.

- Conduct field research at a grocery store on any of the following: product packaging; product origin; product expiration dates; consumer use of plastic, paper, or reusable bags; waste management, etc. Include photographs in your research essay.
- Conduct field research at a waste management facility. Take a tour or attend a class if possible. Many waste management facilities offer educational programs to the public, including classes in home composting.

OPTION #2: Advocacy Project

Step One: Create a 500-word formal communication plan detailing your rationale for taking action and your strategies for reaching your target audience, including the genres and media platforms you intend to use. Audiences must be specific and focused (e.g., local business owners, school administrators, elected representatives, community groups, news organizations, mothers, millennials, etc.). The rationale for the advocacy plan must include research on the issue(s) and evidence-based reasoning supporting your claims. Be sure to cite your sources. Write your communication plan for a professional audience.

NOTE: Communication plans are typically internal documents (i.e., documents only shared within an organization or company). They are written to guide the development of the artifacts (e.g., newsletters, social media posts, PSAs) that will be published for the target audience. You can think of the communication plan as the design specifications for the other texts that will be produced.

Step Two: Now create an artifact or set of artifacts suited to your purpose and audience. These artifacts can be in any genres most appropriate for communicating with the people you are trying to reach. For instance, if your plan is to communicate with other high school students through social media, you can prepare a series of memes or tweets. Alternatively, if your plan is to persuade local business owners to change their practices, then you can write a formal email and/or develop a tri-fold brochure or flyer. Keep in mind your artifact(s) must total 500 to 1,000 words. Cite sources as relevant (e.g., numerical data from www.savethefood.com/ cited in a brochure).

Possible actions and artifacts could include (but are not limited to) the following:

- A proposal for removing plastic straws from the school cafeteria
- A campaign encouraging students and teachers to bring reusable cups, water bottles, and food containers to school
- An education program on how food choices impact the environment
- A Web site featuring tips for waste management
- A cookbook featuring local ingredients
- A “Weigh the Waste” program at your school
- A bilingual guide to home composting
- A proposal for school hydration stations (include cost analysis)
- A newsletter offering tips on grocery shopping and food preparation and storage

A proposal to establish a Food Bus program at your school for lunch leftovers (see foodbus.org).

Activity 13D: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Verb Forms

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

The purpose of Activity 12D is to build students' confidence in making strategic choices about verb forms while clarifying their understanding of the culminating writing assignment. Activity 13D is also designed to help students understand their options for the final writing task while affording them an opportunity to collaborate with their peers. This activity also gives students a chance to practice identifying verbs. Activity 14D provides the closing for the day by allowing each student to share the project type they plan to select.

Activity 13D: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Verb Forms

Double-underline the complete verb phrases and underline the subjects in the following paragraph:

Writers respond to rhetorical situations by taking rhetorical action. That is, they target specific audiences and occasions and use their words to change how others think, act, or feel. For this assignment, you will have your choice of taking rhetorical action through one of two ways: research or advocacy. Students who choose the research option will interpret and synthesize multiple sources that deepen their audience's understanding of the issue. The research option will thus be a reading-based argument essay that may respond directly to Lam's article as one of the sources. Students who choose the advocacy option will develop a communication plan and artifacts (e.g., PSAs, emails, posters, digital stories, tweets, policy recommendations, infographics, etc.) directed at changing their audience's response to the issue. This option can take the form of project-based learning and may involve proposing and/or implementing a change in the students' school or community, such as adopting "The Last Straw" program (a program aimed at eliminating single-use plastics), creating a school composting program, or persuading school administrators and raising funds to install campus hydration stations that encourage the use of refillable water bottles.

Activity 14D: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Comparing Tasks and Choosing Options

Suggested Time: 25 minutes

Activity 14D: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Comparing Tasks and Choosing Options

Using chart paper and working in groups of three or four students, create a Venn diagram comparing and contrasting the research project to the advocacy project (i.e., Option #1 and Option #2). Start by drawing two large, intersecting circles on your chart paper. Label one circle "research project" and the other circle "advocacy project." Then, re-read the description of the writing task in Activity 18 and identify all the verbs associated with each project type that describe what students will do. Work together to complete your Venn diagram, using the verbs you identified to note the similarities and differences between the two projects. For instance, you might write "answer a question at issue" in the intersection between the two circles and write "create a communication plan" in the circle for the advocacy project.

Share your Venn diagrams with the class when finished.

Activity 15D: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Once Around

Suggested Time: 25 minutes

Activity 15D: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Once Around

Briefly tell the class which project type you plan to choose and why. Each student will share.

Day 8

Activity 19: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – The Rubric

You may want to begin class by reviewing the two options for the culminating writing task and asking students if they have any questions about the assignment.

The purpose of this next activity is to orient students to the assessment criteria that will be used to evaluate their work. Encourage students to read the rubric with an eye to what it reveals about the rhetorical situation, including the expectations and values of one of their readers (i.e., their teacher). Remind students that they will also have other audience members, depending on the type of project they select.

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

Activity 19: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – The Rubric

Read the “Rubric for Research or Advocacy Project” that follows. This is the rubric that will be used to assess your performance on the culminating writing task. Then take turns explaining the differences between a score of a “4” and a “3” to a partner.

Rubric for Research or Advocacy Project

Score of 6: A “6” project demonstrates exceptional achievement. It develops a sophisticated line of reasoning appropriate to the genre and context using reading-based argumentation. The evidence is significant and credible. The writer’s choices are strategic and impactful, effectively and compellingly conveying the writer’s message to the intended audience. An exceptional project attends to audience needs, interests, and expectations and communicates its central ideas to the audience through an engaging and appropriate form and style. It also demonstrates mature control over language choices and a sophisticated understanding of the issue. Design choices (including the use of genre features) expertly focus the audience’s attention on key claims or messages. In addition, the project clearly and skillfully addresses a shared need or problem and offers a relevant and insightful response. The text(s) produced make(s) a meaningful contribution to the conversation by offering new or deeper understandings of the issue and/or by promoting significant responses to the issue.

Score of 5: A “5” project demonstrates commendable achievement. It grounds its claims in evidence and develops a line of reasoning appropriate to the genre and context using reading-based argumentation. The writer’s choices are skillful and informed, effectively conveying the writer’s message to the intended audience. While a commendable project attends to audience needs, interests, and expectations, it may be less responsive and nuanced than a “6” project. It nevertheless still communicates its central ideas to the audience through an appropriate form and style. The project also demonstrates control over language choices and a strong understanding of the issue. Design choices

focus the audience's attention on key claims or messages. In addition, the project clearly addresses a shared need or problem and offers a relevant response. The text(s) produced contribute(s) to the conversation by offering new or deeper understandings of the issue and/or by promoting productive responses to the issue.

Score of 4: A "4" project demonstrates adequate achievement. It uses evidence to develop a reading-based argument appropriate to the genre and context. The writer's choices are generally appropriate for the audience and purpose. This project may show less attention to or awareness of audience needs, interests, and expectations. It communicates its ideas to the audience through a generally appropriate form and style although it may occasionally lapse into rhetorical choices not suited to the rhetorical situation. It also demonstrates adequate control over language choices and an adequate (or occasionally superficial) understanding of the issue. Design choices may not consistently help focus the audience's attention on key claims or messages. In addition, the project addresses a shared need or problem and offers an appropriate response. The text(s) produced joins(s) the conversation by offering additional information or understandings and/or by calling for an appropriate response to the issue.

Score of 3: A "3" project demonstrates limited achievement. The writer may have neglected to meet all the project requirements, including requirements for minimum word count and for citation of sources. While the project may include some evidence, the evidence may not be clearly connected to the writer's claims. Evidence may also be insufficient and/or inappropriate to the genre and audience. The central message may also be unclear or underdeveloped. The audience's cares and concerns may receive only minimal attention. The need or problem the project addresses may be implied or unsubstantiated, and the relevance and importance of the response may not be clear. The writing may demonstrate occasional lack of control over language choices.

Score of 2: A "2" project represents an inadequate response to the task. In addition to not meeting all the project requirements, this project may also demonstrate a clear disregard for the rhetorical situation. It may neglect to target an intended audience or identify a clear purpose. The message may be unfocused and confusing, and claims may be unsupported and unconvincing. Choices about genre may likewise show little to no consideration for the rhetorical situation. The writing may demonstrate a consistent lack of control over language choices. These projects may also be unacceptably brief.

Score of 1: A "1" project shows little to no evidence of achievement. It compounds the issues represented by a score of "2" through a response to the task that is notably incomplete and/or inappropriate.

Activity 20: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Choosing a Conversation to Join

Activity 20 supports students in thinking rhetorically about the issues and audiences they'd like to address.

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 20: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Choosing a Conversation to Join

Explore the following questions in a five-minute quickwrite or idea map.

- What's the problem? (exigence)
- What do you want to do about it? (purpose)

- Who has the power to make this change? (audience)
- What's the best way to reach this audience? (genre)
- Why is now the right time to act? (kairos)

Activity 21: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Considering Your Audience

The purpose of Activities 20 and 21 is to prepare students for making appropriate rhetorical decisions in response to the contingencies of their rhetorical situation

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

Activity 21: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Considering Your Audience

Discuss the following questions with a partner before completing the Audience Analysis graphic organizer (see Appendix D).

- What do you need to do in order to convince your audience?
I need to know who is going to be my audience such as women, men, or an age group. I'll need to provide facts, personal experiences, and possible outcomes.
- What's your audience's current mindset on this issue?
My audience's current mindset on this issue is "Why should we change?" or "I am a bit busy and don't have enough time for new changes." They may care about the problem but think it's a hassle to do something about it.
- How much work are you going to need to do to impact this mindset?
I am going to need to put in a lot of work in order to convince my audience, including lots of planning and gathering information. Making an impact is a challenge because people don't want to deal with the issue now.
- If you are writing to an academic audience, what kind of contribution do you hope to make?
I hope to change their food consumption habits, such as not purchasing more than what you will use or throwing out food that's still good. Not enough people think about this as they go about their daily lives.

Activity 22: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Genre and Purpose

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 22: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Genre and Purpose

Discuss the following questions with a partner.

- What do genres tell us about rhetorical situations? What do they tell us about audience expectations?

Genres tell us what we have to do to inform or convince an audience. They can also tell us what kind of information to expect, as well as the type of diction and structure that will most likely be used, depending on whether the rhetoric is more formal and academic or more casual. Genres tell us what kind of story can be told and how.

- “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food” is an op-ed piece. How does this genre influence Lam’s rhetorical choices? How is an op-ed article different from an academic research paper?

An op-ed piece expresses the writer’s opinion on an issue and is more casual than a research paper. Lam’s article was widespread on reach and media, so he had to ensure that it was accessible to as many audiences as possible. He used simpler English, a more casual tone, emotion, and personal stories, and kept his argument concise. He also provided resources for people who wanted more information beyond what an op-ed could offer. An op-ed is an opinion piece with a couple of facts whereas an academic article is a research paper filled with evidence and sources.

- What kind of impact would you like to have? What kind of difference would you like to make?

I would like to inspire people to take action. I want people to think twice before they throw out good food (and all the packaging it comes in) and maybe buy only what they’ll really use.

- What aspects of this topic most interest or concern you?

It interests me how we have let it get this bad, as if we are not caring about what is happening in our world. I’m concerned about people living with food insecurity while so much food goes to waste.

- Where is there a need for more action or information? What kind of contribution can you make?

There is a need for more action in the areas of food packaging, shopping, and storage. There is a lot of evidence but not a lot of things being done to address the problem of food waste and trash. I hope to bring the conversation up again and make people see it a way that finally motivates them to do something.

Designated Module Text – GreenWaste Recovery, “Wasteline”

Activity 16D: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Paragraph Reconstruction

The purpose of this activity is to elicit a paragraph of student writing on the topic of waste management, using a newsletter as a mentor text.

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

Using these paragraphs, teachers can informally diagnose students' strengths and weaknesses in the area of sentence construction. At the end of the activity, students will edit their paragraphs, applying what they have learned about grammar, usage, and mechanics. They will then compare their paragraphs with the original, paying particular attention to verbs, subjects, and sentence structure.

Activity 16D: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Paragraph Reconstruction

In this activity, you will be reconstructing a paragraph your teacher reads aloud to you based on notes you have taken. Try to take notes on both the content of the paragraph and the moves it makes (e.g., transitions, sentence types, verb choices).

1. Take out a blank sheet of paper.
2. Listen as your instructor reads a selected paragraph at a normal rate of speed. Then take notes while your instructor reads the paragraph again; the notes will be essential when composing your paragraph.
3. Reconstruct what you heard using your notes and the keywords. Compare what you have written with other students and make changes as necessary.

Mentor Paragraph for Activity 15D (from the Summer 2017 issue of “Wasteline: A Publication for GreenWaste Recovery Single-family Customers”):

Before throwing away food, consider if it is actually still good. “Best by” dates do not refer to product safety. The only food product dating the federal government regulates is on infant formula and some baby foods. When properly stored, foods remain deliciously nutritious long past printed dates. Trust your senses! Smell and examine food to determine if it is good.

Activity 17D: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – SOAPS

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

SOAPS is a popular strategy for identifying the components of a rhetorical situation.

Activity 17D: Considering Your task and Your Rhetorical Situation – SOAPS

Prepare for your research or advocacy project by considering your rhetorical situation. First, decide which option you choose (Option #1 or Option #2). Then, use the SOAPS strategy to create a quick plan for rhetorical action.

S – What is the subject and question at issue you will be addressing?

Food waste and how to stop it

O – What is the occasion for the rhetorical action you plan to take?

Move-in week on college campuses

A – Who will be your target audience?

New college students who have to do their own shopping and make their own food choices.

P – What do you want to accomplish? Do you want to change what people know, do, or feel?

Reduce food waste and help students save money

S – What role will you take in relation to your audience? What will be your persona or image?

Concerned, realistic young adult who understands how expensive college and food shopping can be and who cares about the environment; someone who faces the same challenges as the audience

Answer each of the questions above in your notes. If you have selected the advocacy project, you may find that some of your answers help you write your communication plan. As you work on your project, think about how you can choose the right words at the right time.

Day 9

Activity 23: Developing a Position – Stasis Theory Questions for “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food”

Stasis theory is a strategy for identifying a question at issue, that is, a question people agree is worth asking but don’t agree about the answer. In the next activities, students will use stasis theory to make their own choices about the question(s) they want to answer, the audience(s) they want to engage, the purpose(s) they want to accomplish, and the best means—including genre and persuasive strategies—of doing so.

If your students need help narrowing their question, stasis theory can be a useful strategy.

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 23: Developing a Position – Stasis Theory Questions for “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food”

For each of the four types of stasis questions that follow, write an additional question about the issue of waste production and/or consumer culture. Use the sample questions in each category to guide your thinking.

This is your opportunity to identify questions at issue that are important to you.

Fact

1. How does waste production impact the environment?
2. What’s the link, if any, between trash production and global warming?
3. How have American consumer habits changed over time?
4. How has garbage production changed over time?
5. What is causing the Great Pacific Garbage Patch?

6. What influences our personal values regarding food, waste, and shopping?
7. My question of fact: _____

Definition

1. What is “American consumerism”? How is it related to concepts like conspicuous consumption or capitalism?
2. What are the key features and principles of waste management?
3. What is materialism? How does it differ from other beliefs or practices?
4. My question of definition: _____

Quality

1. To what extent has human garbage production harmed the environment?
2. What are the benefits and/or costs of American consumer culture?
3. To what extent have waste management practices improved in recent years?
4. What are the benefits and/or costs of plastics production?
5. Are individual rights more or less important than environmental protections?
6. What are the advantages and disadvantages of recycling programs?
7. My question of quality: _____

Policy

1. What should communities do to improve waste management and/or limit waste production?
2. What should be done to address the problem of ocean pollution from plastics?
3. How can we balance the needs of businesses, consumers, and the environment in creating effective policies for waste management?
4. My question of policy: _____

Activity 24: Gathering Relevant Ideas and Materials – Idea Mapping

This activity is intended to help students generate ideas for writing.

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

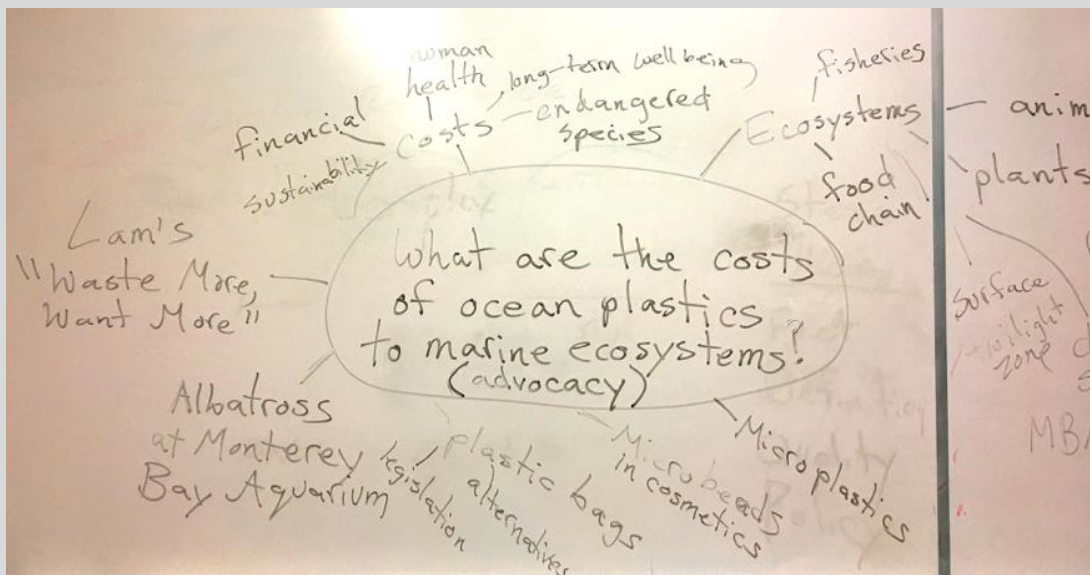
Activity 24: Gathering Relevant Ideas and Materials – Idea Mapping

After selecting the option and question at issue you’d like to respond to, take a few minutes to brainstorm what you already know and to generate new ideas. Write your question at issue in the center of a cluster; note whether you have chosen the research option (Option #1) or the advocacy option (Option #2).

Draw lines branching out from the center of your cluster for ideas related to your question. These could be facts, sources, or examples from the article or from your prior knowledge and experience.

These could also be additional questions you'd like to ask. Group similar ideas together, and continue drawing additional branches out for subsets of ideas.

Compare your idea map to a partner's, and add to your partner's cluster as ideas occur to you. See the sample map that follows:



Activity 25: Gathering Relevant Ideas and Materials – Genre Analysis

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

The next activity uses a close study of mentor texts to develop students' genre awareness. Students may need to complete Activity 25 as homework.

Activity 25: Gathering Relevant Ideas and Materials – Genre Analysis

This activity develops your ability to think rhetorically through a study of the features and functions of different genres. Genre awareness is key to effective communication across contexts. You will be analyzing three different genres for this activity:

- Academic research paper
- Tweets
- Public service announcement poster

For each sample genre, note the form and structure of the text, the type of language or images used, the tone and level of formality of the text, and the communication strategies used. Annotate the text, keeping these features in mind.

Then complete the Genre Feature Analysis Matrix (see Appendix E). Write the genre name on the line for mentor texts. Then, for each mentor text, place a checkmark in the box for each genre feature that is a characteristic of that text. Mark all that apply.

Genre #1: Academic Research Paper (Excerpt)

It has been estimated that 95% of food waste generated in the USA enters a landfill (Buzby et al., 2014). In addition to reducing the reliance on landfills as a waste destination, separating and treating food waste could also reduce methane gas release from landfills. Further, food waste offers the potential for recovery of energy and nutrients, if the food waste is removed from the waste stream entering the landfill and treated. Source reduction is the preferred option in the EPA Food Recovery Hierarchy; however, some amount of food waste is unavoidable, e.g., inedible fractions such as peelings from vegetables. As waste managers consider treatment options it will be valuable to estimate both the edible (i.e., potentially reducible) fraction of food waste and the inedible fraction to understand the potential range of capacity for designing treatment systems.

(Costello, Christine, et al. "Food Waste in Campus Dining Operations: Inventory of Pre- and Post-consumer Mass by Food Category, and Estimation of Embodied Greenhouse Gas Emissions." *Renewable Agriculture and Food Systems*, vol. 31, no. 3, pp. 191-201.)

Genre #2: Tweet

The following tweets are from www.savethefood.com/.

- Food is the largest contributor to US landfills, but we can change that! #SaveTheFood at www.savethefood.com/.
- This @AdCouncil and @NRDC campaign shed light on the important issue of #foodwaste. For tips, www.savethefood.com/.
- Thrilled to @SaveTheFood with @AdCouncil and @NRDC because 40% of food never gets eaten. Visit www.savethefood.com/.
- Americans are wasting a whopping 40% of food, but together, we can #SaveTheFood with @SaveTheFood
- We love our food to be eaten. Check out the #SaveTheFood campaign at www.savethefood.com/ for more info!
- Love this awesome #SaveTheFood campaign by @NRDC and @AdCouncil. Follow @SaveTheFood for tips!

Genre #3: Public Service Announcement Poster

The following poster is from www.savethefood.com/.



Activity 18D: Gathering Relevant Ideas and Materials – Genre Analysis of a Mentor Text

Suggested Time: 25 minutes

Activity 18D: Considering Your Task and Your Rhetorical Situation – Genre Analysis of a Mentor Text

In this activity, you will continue developing your genre analysis skills. Genre awareness involves paying attention to the special characteristics of different types of oral and written communication. Noticing the kind of language used in particular genres can help you communicate effectively.

Step One: Read and annotate “Wasteline,” the newsletter for GreenWaste Recovery’s customers. GreenWaste Recovery is a recycling and trash collection company in California. Practice noticing language by doing the following:

- Mark words, phrases, or sentences that may be confusing, writing down brief notes explaining what about them is confusing.
- Identify grammatical patterns such as verb tenses, time markers (last week, since, tomorrow), modal verbs (can, could, must, might, should), or singular and plural noun forms.
- Analyze the logical relationships between the parts of sentences.

Step Two: Take out your Genre Feature Analysis Matrix and add the “Wasteline” newsletter to your list of mentor texts. Work with a partner or small group to analyze the genre features of the newsletter. Place a checkmark in the box for each genre feature that is a characteristic of “Wasteline.” Mark all that apply.

Step Three: Continue collaboratively analyzing the special features and functions of the newsletter by completing the Genre Analysis graphic organizer (see Appendix F). Talk with your group members about the purpose of “Wasteline” and the audience for this newsletter. Note any special or unusual features. Describe the image or ethos GreenWaste Recovery projects of itself. Record your notes in your graphic organizer.

Activity 19D: Gathering Relevant Ideas and Materials – Mentor Text Analysis

Suggested Time: 25 minutes

Activity 19D: Gathering Relevant Ideas and Materials – Mentor Text Analysis

Work collaboratively to analyze the features of the FAQ from the www.savethefood.com/ Web site. This document describes the organization’s communication plan. If you have chosen the advocacy option for the culminating module assignment, you will be creating your own communication plan for your project.

Step One: Read the FAQ. You’ll notice that it identifies “mothers and millennials” as the target audience for the public awareness campaign. The millennial generation includes young adults in their 30s and late 20s. Millennials typically have jobs or careers and are the age when people often think of getting married, setting up a household, and starting a family. In other words, these are people who may be doing a lot of consumer spending—unlike teenagers and college students who may have little disposable income.

Step Two: Discuss the questions that follow with a partner.

- Why do you think the campaign has chosen to focus on millennials and mothers?
They think these people do a lot of shopping and cooking.
- What assumptions does the campaign make about mothers?
That women are the ones who are doing the shopping and cooking. They don’t think that fathers do the grocery shopping.
- What kinds of things might be important to mothers as consumers? How do they decide what to buy? What are their concerns and priorities?

Step Three: Conduct a whole-class analysis of one of the www.savethefood.com/ campaign’s target audiences: mothers. Start by drawing a circle in your note and writing “cares and concerns of mothers” in the center. Then create a cluster by brainstorming things that might be important to mothers when they buy groceries for their family.

Possible student responses: Value, price, nutrition, quantity, convenience, health, practicality

Step Four: Now conduct an audience analysis of the people you want to reach through your Research or Advocacy Project. What are their cares and concerns? How can they help you to make a difference or accomplish your purpose? How can you appeal to them through the things that are already important to them?

For additional digital mentor texts, search the hashtags #marinedebris or #PlasticPollution on Twitter or see the Web site plasticadrift.org.

Day 10

Activity 26: Gathering Relevant Ideas and Materials – Keyword Searches

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 26: Gathering Relevant Ideas and Materials – Keyword Searches

Brainstorm a list of keywords or phrases for database searches that can help you find more sources for your research or advocacy project. You can use these same words or phrases to focus your audience’s attention when you compose your own text(s) later on. Use the table that follows to create a bank of key terms.

<i>waste management</i>	<i>consumption</i>	

Writing Rhetorically

Composing a Draft

Activity 27: Making Choices about Learning Goals

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 27: Making Choices about Learning Goals

Take a moment to revisit the goals you set earlier in the module and set new learning goals for your development as a writer. What skills, knowledge, or dispositions do you especially want to develop while working on the final writing task? Write a few ideas in your notes.

Activity 28: Making Choices as You Write – Genre

Activities 28-29 (Making Choices as You Write) are designed to help students make moment-by-moment choices about implementing genre conventions, selecting relevant and compelling evidence, and discovering the most effective organizing strategy for their text.

The purpose of this activity is to engage students in a study of a model of the kind of writing that they are going to be doing themselves. This kind of genre analysis helps students learn from the moves of other writers while reflecting on their own process for making rhetorical decisions.

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

Activity 28: Making Choices as You Write – Genre

In this activity, you will conduct a genre analysis of a mentor text. Find a text that is a good example of the genre you plan to write in (e.g., research paper, newsletter, tri-fold brochure, business email). Start by using the Genre Feature Analysis Matrix (Appendix E) to note key characteristics of this genre. Then use the Genre Analysis graphic organizer (Appendix F) to describe the form and function of this genre in greater detail. Use your analysis of your mentor text to make choices about genre conventions as you write.

Pairs Conversation: What did you notice about the features and functions of your mentor text? How might these observations influence your own choices about the genre as you write?

What choices do you plan to make as you write in this genre yourself?

Activity 29: Making Choices as You Write – Outlining

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 29 supports students in thinking about the organization and presentation of their ideas. These design features will vary according to the genres students have selected.

Activity 29: Making Choices as You Write – Outlining

Use your notes from your research and your Genre Analysis graphic organizer to create a quick outline or plan. If your text has visual components, include these in your outline or plan.

Activity 30: Making Choices as You Write – Composing Your Draft

In Activity 30, students generate a first draft of their research paper or communication plan. You may choose to assign this activity as homework.

Activity 30: Making Choices as You Write – Composing Your Draft

Begin writing the first draft of your research paper or communication plan. If you chose the advocacy option, you can develop your artifacts after drafting your communication plan. Many questions you may now have about your project will be answered in the process of writing itself. Use your draft to discover what you think.

Revising Rhetorically

Activity 20D: Gathering and Responding to Feedback – Small Group Writing Conferences

Suggested Time: 50 minutes

Participating as a writing group member as the teacher provides an enhanced level of support. Because you will be occupied with one group at a time, the rest of the class will need an alternative activity to work on. This could be Sustained Silent Reading (SSR) or an extended revision lab.

Start by dividing the class into groups of four. You'll need to allow at least 10 minutes per group (20 minutes is preferable). Meet with each group individually, guiding students through a shared writing conference by following the directions in Activity 19D.

Activity 20D: Gathering and Responding to Feedback – Small Group Writing Conferences

Meet with your peers and teacher for a small-group writing conference to discuss your draft of your Research or Advocacy Project. If possible, bring three hard copies of your draft for your group members to write on—or share your work with your group members electronically (be sure they have editing privileges, so they can insert comments). Start with a silent read-around of everyone's drafts. As you read, write or insert comments on the writers' drafts letting them know what they're doing well (e.g., "helpful example" and "good observation") and asking questions that can help the writers further develop and support their ideas (e.g., "What do you mean by this?" and "Can you provide evidence for this claim?").

End the conference by returning drafts to their owners and talking with your teacher about next steps for revision. Be sure you understand the feedback you received from your peers and teacher.

Day 11

Negotiating Voices

Help students review the choices they made for using the words of others. While not all student compositions will include direct quotations and paraphrases with parenthetical citations, all will include citations. Advocacy projects are more likely to summarize sources than to quote or paraphrase them. Offer your students support negotiating voices and perspectives as relevant to their projects.

Revising Rhetorically

Activity 31: Analyzing Your Draft Rhetorically

Suggested Time: 20 minutes

A PAPA Square analysis can help students identify and evaluate the rhetorical choices they made in their draft in light of their rhetorical situation. After students complete their analysis, allow time for meaningful revision. If your students are familiar with the concept of **kairos**, you may also invite them to consider the extent to which they've used "the right words at the right time."

Activity 31: Analyzing Your Draft Rhetorically

The revision stage is another good opportunity to take control over your writing. Start by assessing your knowledge of your subject. Ask yourself if your understanding of your content is sufficient—and if you have made this understanding sufficiently clear to your readers. What are the most important factors that can contribute to the success of your research or advocacy project?

Step One: Complete a rhetorical analysis of your draft by using a PAPA Square (see Appendix G).

Step Two: Compare your draft to a mentor text you examined for the “Genre Analysis” activities (Activity 23, 18D, or 26). Be sure the mentor text is the same genre as your draft. What do you notice? Do you need to make any changes in genre choices to ensure you are addressing your audience’s expectations for this form of communication?

For instance, if you are writing an academic research paper, consider the extent to which your draft follows the conventions of scholarly writing. If your research paper seems to share more characteristics with a newsletter than an academic essay, you may want to revise your diction, syntax, evidence, and/or text structure.

Step Three: Finally, consider your use of time markers or whether time markers are needed. Think about the extent to which the language of kairos (i.e., language signaling the opportune moment or immediate social situation) can strengthen your message or argument. Have you addressed important contexts or social moments? Have you conveyed a sense of the timeliness of your message? Are you taking advantage of available opportunities for persuasion?

Activity 32: Gathering and Responding to Feedback

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

Guiding students to look for the same types of features in their own writing that they have observed in the mentor texts they have analyzed (including “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food” by Andrew Lam) and to consider incorporating these features if relevant can make students more thoughtful in crafting their own style.

Activity 32: Gathering and Responding to Reader Feedback

You will need a partner for this activity. Partner A will read a paragraph aloud from their research paper or communication plan. After Partner A reads the paragraph, Partner B will explain what they understand and what they don’t understand in the paragraph. Partner A will continue reading their work aloud, stopping after each paragraph to allow Partner B a chance to respond. After Partner A finishes reading, the pair will switch roles.

Be sure to keep your reader feedback focused on the following two kinds of responses:

- What you understand
- What you need to help to understand

As you revise your work, consider ways to help your reader more fully understand your message and purpose.

Editing

Activity 33: Editing Your Draft – Proofreading

The purpose of this next activity is to guide students in producing a relatively error-free copy of their final work. This activity may be assigned as homework.

Activity 33: Editing Your Draft – Proofreading

Choose a section of your research paper or communication plan to read in reverse. Scan your eyes from right to left across the page, reading the words backward. Pay special attention to verb tenses and time markers.

Reading a text backwards can sometimes help you detect errors that you miss during a regular reading. Be sure your work has been carefully proofread before you share it with your intended audience.

Activity 20D: Gathering and Responding to Feedback – Small Group Writing Conferences (continued)

Suggested Time: 35 minutes

Continue meeting in small groups with your teacher to share your work in progress.

Activity 21D: Editing Your Draft – Sample Student Paragraph

The purpose of this activity is to give students practice editing a piece of student writing before they apply what they have learned to their own writing

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

Have students independently edit the sample student paragraph below.

If you need the full period to facilitate small-group writing conferences, you may assign Activity 20D as homework. Students may then continue revising and editing their Research or Advocacy Project outside of class.

Activity 21D: Editing Your Draft – Sample Student Paragraph

Read the following student paragraph on the topic of waste production. Edit the essay using the conventions of academic English. Pay careful attention to verb tenses, time markers, spelling, and punctuation. Make any changes you think will improve the paragraph, including using the present or past progressive verb tense to show ongoing action.

You can make your changes in the essay itself. Use the margins or the bottom of the page if you need more room to revise sentences.

Sample Student Paragraph:

In the article “Waste More, Want More: America Throws Out Good Food,” by Andrew Lam, he detailed the lifestyle of American citizens and how they impacted the world on a global scale, his research showed Americans in a light that we should be ashamed of. In his article, he stated a fact based on our garbage production, “The United States has less than 5 percent of the world’s population, yet it consumes more than 30 percent of the world’s energy resources and generates 70 percent of the total global toxic waste.” The data Lam stated was sad to read and shows how wasteful we were with resources that an average developing country would love to have. The toxin’s the United States produces and putting into the air hurts the environment and not only affects those around the world but also hurts its own people. It has now become a custom and a habit to just waste something not knowing exactly what we throw away does to our own environment and affects those around us. It’s especially bad with food. We literally throw money down the drain as if we expect it to always be. We will have to pay extra for the food we import or search threw garbage bins for edible goods. This situation would most likely be unpleasant for one for most of the American population as many families already struggling to make ends meet. However, we still have a chance to change our behavior and a better and healthier planet.

Day 12**Activity 34: Preparing Your Draft for Publication**

Day 12 may take place several days after Day 11 if necessary since students may need additional time to complete their projects before submitting their work.

In addition to submitting their work to you for a grade, your students may also find numerous other opportunities to share their work with a wider audience. Public comment periods on proposed legislation or policy related to waste management can provide important opportunities for civic engagement. Search for current public comment periods related to your students’ research and advocacy projects and encourage them to join the discussion if possible. Students who developed communication plans should also be encouraged to put those plans into action.

Framing the submission of their final work as “publication” reminds students that the purpose of writing rhetorically is to send their work out into the world. Encourage students who wrote for an external audience to send their work if possible. While this may be done outside of or at the start of class, you may also choose to include this step in Activity 35: Presentation of Research or Advocacy Projects.

Activity 34: Preparing Your Draft for Publication

The final step in the writing process is ensuring your composition reaches its intended audience. Beyond submitting your work to your teacher, where else can it go? If you wrote a series a Tweets for an advocacy project, try tweeting them and see what kind of response you receive. If you wrote a letter to a local restaurant owner regarding plastic straws, send your letter.

You may also be able to share your research and insights through a public comment period related to waste management if a suitable opportunity presents itself. Public comment periods frequently last for four or five weeks, allowing citizens a limited window of opportunity to respond to proposed legislation or public policy.

Recent public comment periods in California have addressed bans on plastic bags, monofill dump sites (garbage dumps that allow only a single type of trash, such as tires), and chemical waste disposal.

See the following link for a summary of public comments from 2017 on the California Ocean Litter Prevention Strategy:

www.opc.ca.gov/webmaster/_media_library/2017/11/Draft_Strategy_PublicComment.pdf.

Activity 35: Preparing Your Draft for Publication – Presentation of Research or Advocacy Projects

The purpose of this activity is to afford students the opportunity to share their projects with their classroom community, in addition to “publishing” their work to their teacher and relevant external audiences.

Suggested Time: 30 minutes

Choose a presentation format (roundtable, panel presentation, lightning talks, etc.) that works for your class.

Activity 35: Preparing Your Draft for Publication – Presentation of Research or Advocacy Projects

Share your work with your classmates via an appropriate presentation strategy. This will be an informal opportunity to publish your work and celebrate your success.

Activity 36: Reflecting on Your Writing Process

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 36: Reflecting on Your Writing Process

Take a few minutes to reflect on your growth as a writer and your success on the final writing task. Think again about the characteristics of the mentor texts you studied. Then evaluate the effectiveness of your performance in each of the following areas on a scale of 1 to 5.

	1 = Needs Improvement	5 = Highly Effective
1 2 3 4 5	Meeting audience expectation and need	
1 2 3 4 5	Engaging your audience’s attention and concern	
1 2 3 4 5	Choosing the right moment and setting for rhetorical action	
1 2 3 4 5	Choosing the right genre for your audience and purpose	
1 2 3 4 5	Conveying a message supported by research and critical reasoning	
1 2 3 4 5	Presenting your message clearly and compellingly	
1 2 3 4 5	Using genre conventions effectively and thoughtfully	
1 2 3 4 5	Likelihood of achieving your purpose	

Activity 37: Reflecting on Your Learning Goals – Reflective Quickwrite

Suggested Time: 10 minutes

Activity 37: Reflecting on Your Learning Goals – Reflective Quickwrite

Finally, revisit the questions you asked yourself at the start of this module:

1. What strengths do I have as a reader and writer that I can build on?
2. What do I want to learn how to do or do better?
3. What do I need to keep me moving forward in my intellectual growth?

What learning goals did you set for yourself? Locate these in your notes. What did you do to imagine and create your success as you engaged the learning experiences in this module?

Reflect on your learning goals in a five-minute quickwrite.

Activity 22D: Editing Your Draft – Final Review: List, Group, Label

The purpose of this activity is to guide students in reviewing key skills and concepts and in generating their own schema for organizing their learning

Suggested Time: 35 minutes

Activity 22D: Editing Your Draft – Final Review: List, Group, Label

Below is a list of terms, concepts, and strategies from this module. Working in groups of three or four students, organize this content into categories that make sense to you. Start by sorting the items into related groups. Then give each group a label describing its content (e.g., “Rhetorical Appeals”). Use a piece of chart paper to record your work and be prepared to share your labeled groups with the class. Be prepared, too, to justify the categories you created for the items in the list.

If you are unsure of what an item is, consult your notes or ask your group members or teacher.

advocacy	annotation	audience analysis
citations	claims	common ground
database	descriptive outlining	editing
ethos	evidence	genre analysis
genre awareness	infinitive	logos
mentor text	modal verbs	PAPA Square
pathos	proofreading	publication
purpose analysis	question of definition	question of fact
question of policy	question of quality	reflection

research	rhetorical situation	SOAPS
stasis theory	subject	text structure
time markers	verb phrase	verb tenses
verbal adjective	verbal noun (gerund)	works cited list

Activity 23D: Reflecting on Your Learning Goals – Student-Generated Test Questions

The purpose of this activity is to assess what learning students consider important, what kinds of questions they consider fair, and how well they understand the key content.

Suggested Time: 15 minutes

In this activity, students write questions for a possible quiz after studying the material. Questions could be multiple choice, multiple select, matching, or constructed response. (See “Formative Assessment for ERWC 3.0: Professional Learning” by Norman Unrau and the accompanying appendix “Strategies for Formative Assessment.”)

Activity 23D: Reflecting on Your Learning Goals – Student-Generated Test Questions

Working in your same group of three or four students and using the content from the List, Group, Label activity, create a set of six questions that could be used to assess student learning. Discuss which skills, concepts, and categories from List, Group, Label your group consider most important to success in college and career. Questions can be multiple choice, multiple select, matching, or constructed response (short answer).

Pose your best question to the class when finished.

Reflecting on Your Teaching Process

After reading your students’ reflective quick-writes (see Activity 35) and evaluating your students’ Research or Advocacy Projects, take a few minutes to plan your next instructional moves. What do you need to do to continue to support your students’ intellectual growth? What’s the next step forward for your students? What skills and concepts spiral through the curriculum? How will you know when your students have achieved mastery?

Consider the opportunities you plan to provide students, including English language learners, for further exploring, practicing, and mastering the following competencies:

- Understanding and responding to rhetorical situations
- Analyzing genre features and making choices about the genre
- Understanding the effects and functions of verb choices
- Using time markers to signal shifts and frame contexts

Appendixes

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Appendix A

Annotation/Summary/Response Rubric

Once students have completed their Summary and Response papers, you can collect the annotation and summary/response and grade them using the following rubric.

1 = serious problems 2 = developing competence 3 = minimal competence 4 = clear competence

1 2 3 4	Annotation: The writer has systematically annotated the reading, identifying the main idea, major points, and important examples. The writer has also included some personal reaction.
1 2 3 4 (x 2) = _____	Content of the Summary: The writer clearly states the title and the author and then demonstrates concise understanding of the focus of the passage. The writer includes all the important supporting points and examples but excludes unnecessary detail and personal opinion.
1 2 3 4	Organization of the Summary: The paragraph begins with a sentence(s) accurately explaining the main idea of the passage, and the organization is logical, generally coinciding with the original organizational pattern. The writer effectively uses transitions and concludes appropriately.
1 2 3 4	Content of the Response: The writer clearly describes a personal connection to one or more ideas in the passage, using thoughtful detail and appropriate register.
1 2 3 4	Language: The writer communicates in his/her own words showing consistent control of language conventions and effective use of vocabulary.

Directions: Circle the number in each category that best describes the student's proficiency. Multiply the "Content of the Summary" by 2. Add the numbers and then divide by 6 to get an average score.

Total _____

Average _____ (Total divided by 6)

Descriptive Outlining

Paragraph[s]:

Says:

Does:

Paragraph[s]:

Says:

Does:

Paragraph[s]:

Says:

Does:

Paragraph[s]:

Says:

Does:

Paragraph[s]:

Says:

Does:

Paragraph[s]:

Says:

Does:

Paragraph[s]:

Says:

Does:

Paragraph[s]:

Says:

Does:

Main Argument:

Logos Analysis

<u>Author's claim/position:</u>		
<u>Support & Evidence</u>		
<u>Authority/Experts:</u> List any expert testimony the writer includes.	<u>Facts/Statistics:</u> List any numerical data or scientific evidence the writer uses.	<u>Qualifiers/Transitions:</u> List words and phrases like "some," "often," "perhaps," "as a result," or "on the other hand" that qualify claims or signal logical relationships.
<u>Counterarguments:</u> List any opposing views the writer mentions.		
Quickwrite: How reasonable does this writer seem to you? Is the writer careful to make claims that can be supported by evidence? Does the writer seem fair and unbiased? Does the writer consider different viewpoints? Make concessions?		

Appendix D

Audience Analysis

Writer's claim/position

What does the writer say?

Audience**Characteristics**

Describe the key traits of this audience (age, education, community, region, gender, class, ethnicity).

Motives and/or Interests

Describe what is important to this audience. What do they want?

Required Response

Describe what the writer wants this audience to do (make a decision, take action, change beliefs, etc.).

World View

What values, beliefs, or assumptions might members of this audience share?

Quick Write

How would you describe the audience of this text? How are the writer's rhetorical choices (eg. language, structure, evidence, appeals, etc. suited to the needs, interests, expectations of this audience? Explain.

Appendix E

Genre Feature Analysis Matrix

Name of Genre:_____.

Directions to Students: Create a list of 4-6 titles of mentor texts that are examples of the genre you are analyzing. Write the titles of these texts in the far left column. Then, for each mentor text, place a check mark in the box for each genre feature that is a characteristic of that text. Mark all that apply.

Mentor Texts	Rhetorical and Literary Devices								Language Choices							Organization					Special Features							Context and Community					Medium						
	figurative language	imagery	rhyme scheme	scholarly evidence	personal anecdotes	fictional characters	symbolism	plot	setting	simple sentences	complex sentences	formal diction	casual diction	academic English	specialized vocabulary	first-person "I"	headings	chapters	stanzas	cause and effect text structure	compare and contrast text structure	narrative text structure	dialogue	charts or tables	visuals	footnotes or endnotes	citations	index	stage directions	discipline-specific	specialized	broad	time-sensitive	age-specific	oral communication	written communication	visual rhetoric		

Genre Analysis

Genre Name: _____

Mentor Texts:

List the titles of several texts that exemplify the key characteristics of this genre.

Purpose:**Organization:**

How are texts in this genre generally structured (e.g., chronological order, compare and contrast, etc.)? Are there paragraphs, stanzas, dialogue, chapters, lists, headings, etc.? Do texts usually have a certain kind of beginning or end?

Language Choices:

Describe the kinds of words and sentences commonly used in this genre. Is the language typically formal or casual, simple or complex?

Writer's Ethos:

How do writers generally present themselves in this genre? What kind of "voice" do they typically use? Do you get to know the writer personally?

Special Features:

List any other conventions or stylistic choices that characterize this genre, including features like documentation style (e.g., MLA), figurative language, pictures, and rhetorical moves.

Context and Audience: In what situations is this type of writing typically used? Who typically reads this genre?

Appendix G

PAPA SQUARE

PURPOSE

RHETORICAL DEVICES AND STRATEGIES

AUDIENCE

ARGUMENT

PERSONA

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